

72nd BPSC PRELIMS

प्रहार

Test Series

Test- 03

Current Affairs

Solution

English



Khan Global Studies

Most Trusted Learning Platform

BPSC PRELIMS TEST - 3 (SOLUTION)

Q 1. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Anji Khad Bridge:
 - ✓ India's first cable-stayed railway bridge.
 - ✓ Located between Katra and Reasi in Jammu and Kashmir.
 - ✓ Built over the Anji River, a tributary of the Chenab River.
 - ✓ Part of the Udhampur–Srinagar–Baramulla Rail Link (USBRL) project.
- Key facts:
 - ✓ Chenab Bridge (Jammu and Kashmir):
 - Highest railway bridge in the world.
 - Height: 359 meters above the river bed, taller than the Eiffel Tower.
 - ✓ Bogibeel Bridge (Assam):
 - India's longest rail-cum-road bridge.
 - Built across the Brahmaputra River.
 - ✓ Atal Tunnel (Himachal Pradesh):
 - Longest highway tunnel above 10,000 feet.
 - Passes through the Pir Panjal Range below Rohtang Pass.
 - ✓ Bhupen Hazarika Setu (Assam–Arunachal Pradesh):
 - Also called the Dhola–Sadiya Bridge.
 - Longest bridge over water in India (9.15 km).
 - Built across the Lohit River, a tributary of the Brahmaputra.

Q 2. Ans. B

Explanation:

- National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) – Chairperson Appointment (2025)
 - ✓ Chairperson: Justice V. Ramasubramanian
 - ✓ Former position: Judge of the Supreme Court of India
 - ✓ Appointment year: Early 2025
 - ✓ Appointing process: Recommendation by high-level committee
 - ✓ Committee chaired by: Prime Minister
- NHRC – Statutory Background
 - ✓ Nature: Statutory body (not constitutional)
 - ✓ Establishment: 12 October 1993

- ✓ Act: Protection of Human Rights Act (PHRA), 1993
- ✓ Function: Human rights watchdog in India

● Appointment Process

- ✓ Appointing authority: President of India
- ✓ Recommendation committee (6 members):
 - ✓ Prime Minister (Chairperson)
 - ✓ Speaker of Lok Sabha
 - ✓ Deputy Chairman of Rajya Sabha
 - ✓ Leader of Opposition (Lok Sabha)
 - ✓ Leader of Opposition (Rajya Sabha)
 - ✓ Union Home Minister

● Eligibility Criteria (2019 Amendment)

- ✓ Earlier rule: Only retired Chief Justice of India eligible
- ✓ Current rule: Retired CJI or Supreme Court Judge eligible

● Tenure

- ✓ Duration: 3 years or until age 70 (whichever earlier)
- ✓ Reappointment: Eligible

Q 3. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Action: Withdrawal from World Health Organisation (WHO)
- Issued by: President Donald Trump (post-inauguration)
- Reason cited:
 - ✓ Mishandling of COVID-19 pandemic
 - ✓ Alleged lack of independence from Chinese influence
- WHO establishment: 7 April 1948
 - ✓ World Health Day: 7 April
 - ✓ Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland
 - ✓ U.S. role: Founding member
 - ✓ Financial contribution: ~\$400–500 million annually (historically largest donor)

Q 4. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Pralay Missile
 - ✓ Type: Surface-to-Surface Ballistic Missile (SRBM)
 - ✓ Developed by: DRDO (Defence Research and Development Organisation)

- ✓ Category: Short-range ballistic missile
- ✓ Deployment areas: LAC (Line of Actual Control), LoC (Line of Control)
- Characteristics
 - ✓ Launch platform: Ground-based mobile canister system
 - ✓ Operational range: 150 km – 500 km
 - ✓ Propulsion: Solid propellant rocket motor
 - ✓ Status: Conventional (non-nuclear capable in operational role)
- Key Features
 - ✓ Trajectory type: Quasi-ballistic missile
 - ✓ Flight pattern: Low-altitude maneuvering trajectory
 - ✓ Capability: Mid-course maneuvering
 - ✓ Advantage: Hard to intercept by missile defence systems
- Navigation and Guidance
 - ✓ System: Advanced inertial navigation system
 - ✓ Avionics: Integrated avionics suite
 - ✓ Feature: High precision targeting capability

Q 5. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Eklavya Digital Learning Portal
 - ✓ User: Indian Army
 - ✓ Type: Digital learning + knowledge management platform
 - ✓ Purpose: Officer training modernisation
 - ✓ Theme for 2024 as the “Year of Technology Absorption.”
- Objectives
 - ✓ Centralised access: Academic resources
 - ✓ Training support: Officer professional development
 - ✓ Learning mode: Self-paced courses
 - ✓ Resource base: Research papers + military journals
- Key Features
 - ✓ Platform type: Secure digital repository
 - ✓ Content access:
 - ✓ Academic resources
 - ✓ Digitised military journals
 - ✓ Research papers
 - ✓ Training modules
 - ✓ Accessibility: Anywhere–anytime learning
 - ✓ Coverage: Officers across postings
- Strategic Impact

- ✓ Officer benefit: Continuous professional learning
- ✓ Deployment benefit: Remote border accessibility
- ✓ Examples of deployment zones:
 - Siachen
 - Tawang
- ✓ Outcome: Maintains strategic + academic readiness
- Related Initiatives
 - ✓ Project SAMARTH: HR digitisation in the Army
 - ✓ Project BHISHM: Portable disaster medical infrastructure cubes

Q 6. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Green GDP Framework
 - ✓ State: Chhattisgarh
 - ✓ Year: January 2025
 - ✓ First in India: Yes
 - ✓ Initiative: Linking forest ecosystem services with Green GDP
- Concept
 - ✓ Green GDP linkage: Integration of forest ecosystem services into economic accounting
 - ✓ Purpose: Value “invisible” ecological services in monetary terms
- Ecosystem Services Valued
 - ✓ Carbon sequestration: Monetary value of CO₂ absorption
 - ✓ Water recharge: Economic value of forest-based water provision
 - ✓ Biodiversity maintenance: Contribution to ecological balance and agriculture support
- Economic Integration
 - ✓ System: Integrated into State economic growth calculation (GSDP-linked Green GDP)
 - ✓ Approach: Converts ecological services into measurable economic inputs
- State Context
 - ✓ Forest cover: ~44.2% of the state area
 - ✓ Role: Major carbon sink of Central India

Additional Information

- Jharkhand:
 - ✓ Initiative: Green Economic Diversification Roadmap (Dec 2025)

- ✓ Focus: Shift from mining economy → renewable energy + green hydrogen
- Odisha:
 - ✓ Focus: Industrial policy + semiconductor + digital economy
- Madhya Pradesh:
 - ✓ Strength: Highest forest cover among states
 - ✓ Focus areas: Renewable energy (e.g., Omkareshwar Floating Solar Project) + carbon markets
- **Green GDP formula:** GDP – Environmental Costs

Q 7. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Shikari Devi Wildlife Sanctuary
 - ✓ Location: Himachal Pradesh
 - ✓ Forest divisions: Nachan + Karsog
- Objective
 - ✓ Purpose: Buffer protection for wildlife sanctuary
 - ✓ Function: Prevent impact of urbanisation and unregulated development
- Ecological Characteristics
 - ✓ Altitude range: 1,800 m – 3,400 m
- Vegetation zones:
 - ✓ Pine forests
 - ✓ Oak forests
 - ✓ Alpine meadows
- Key fauna:
 - ✓ Snow Leopard
 - ✓ Himalayan Black Bear
 - ✓ Western Tragopan (state bird of Himachal Pradesh)

Q 8. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ PM-YUVA scheme: Implemented by National Book Trust (NBT), India
 - ✓ Administrative ministry: Ministry of Education
 - ✓ Policy linkage: Aligned with National Education Policy (NEP) 2020
 - ✓ Objective focus: Empower young writers and create learning ecosystem
- Statement 2 is incorrect:
 - ✓ YUVA acronym: Young, Upcoming and Versatile Authors

- ✓ Age eligibility: Below 30 years
- ✓ Not eligible: Above 30 years
- Statement 3 is correct:
 - ✓ PM-YUVA 3.0 themes:
 - Contribution of Indian Diaspora in Nation Building
 - Indian Knowledge System (IKS)
 - Makers of Modern India (1950–2025)
- Key supporting facts:
 - ✓ Financial assistance:
 - Scholarship amount: ₹50,000 per month
 - Mentorship duration: 6 months
 - ✓ Publication details:
 - Publishing body: National Book Trust (NBT)
 - Languages accepted: 22 official Indian languages and English
 - Royalty: 10% lifetime royalty on book sales
 - ✓ National initiative linkage:
 - Supports: Ek Bharat Shreshtha Bharat
 - Purpose: Promote Indian culture, heritage, and contemporary progress globally

Q 9. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Justice Dinesh Maheshwari:** Appointed Chairperson of 23rd Law Commission of India
- Appointment date: April 2025
- **Key Facts on 23rd Law Commission:**
 - ✓ Constitution of 23rd Law Commission: September 2024
 - ✓ Tenure duration: 3 years
 - ✓ Tenure end date: August 31, 2027
- Additional facts:
 - ✓ Justice Ranjan Gogoi:
 - 46th Chief Justice of India
 - Current role: Nominated member of Rajya Sabha
 - Award: Assam Baibhav (Highest civilian award of Assam)
 - ✓ Justice N.V. Ramana:
 - 48th Chief Justice of India
 - Post-retirement role: Promotes Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR)
 - Institutional role: Founding role in International Arbitration and Mediation Centre (IAMC), Hyderabad

- ✓ Justice U.U. Lalit:
 - 49th Chief Justice of India
 - Special fact: Second CJI elevated directly from Bar to Supreme Court
 - Tenure length as CJI: 74 days
 - Tenure year: 2022
- Key facts:
 - ✓ Nature of Law Commission of India: Non-statutory body
 - ✓ Type: Executive body
 - ✓ Constituted by: Government of India notification
 - ✓ First Law Commission of Independent India:
 - Year: 1955
 - Chairperson: M.C. Setalvad
 - ✓ Composition of 23rd Law Commission:
 - Chairperson: 1
 - Full-time members: 4 (including Member-Secretary)
 - Ex-officio members: 2
 - Ex-officio posts: Law Secretary, Legislative Secretary
 - Ministry linkage: Ministry of Law and Justice
 - ✓ Core functions of Law Commission:
 - Advisory body to: Ministry of Law and Justice
 - ✓ Key roles:
 - Identify obsolete laws for repeal
 - Review existing legislation
 - Examine socio-legal issues
 - ✓ Major policy subjects examined:
 - Uniform Civil Code (UCC)
 - One Nation One Election
 - ✓ Preceding Commission:
 - 22nd Law Commission Chairperson: Justice Ritu Raj Awasthi
 - Tenure ended early due to: Appointment as Judicial Member of Lokpal
- Total sanctioned credit flow: Over ₹148.99 crore.
- Primary impact: Promotion of non-farm micro-enterprises and self-employment.
- Top Performing States/UTs in PMEGP FY 2024–25:
 - ✓ First: Jammu and Kashmir
 - ✓ Second: Tamil Nadu
 - ✓ Third: Bihar
- Additional facts:
 - ✓ PMEGP launch year: 2008
 - Scheme type: Central sector scheme.
 - Scheme nature: Credit-linked subsidy scheme.
 - ✓ Merged schemes under PMEGP:
 - Prime Minister's Rojgar Yojana (PMRY).
 - Rural Employment Generation Programme (REGP).
 - ✓ Administrative ministry: Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME).
 - ✓ Nodal agency at national level: Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC).
 - ✓ Implementing agencies at local level:
 - State KVIC Directorates.
 - State Khadi and Village Industries Boards (KVIBs).
 - District Industries Centres (DICs).
 - ✓ Margin money subsidy range: 15% to 35%.
 - ✓ Higher subsidy eligibility: SC, ST, Women, Rural enterprises.
 - ✓ Maximum project cost limits:
 - Manufacturing sector: ₹50 lakh.
 - Service sector: ₹20 lakh.
 - ✓ Socio-economic objective:
 - Reduce outward labour migration.
 - Promote grassroots entrepreneurship.
 - Convert job seekers into job creators.

Q 10. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Bihar's rank in PMEGP implementation in FY 2024–25: Third
- Performance Details:
- Sanction rate achieved by Bihar: 115% of target.
- Projects sanctioned: Over 8,000.
- Total applications received: About 35,400.

Q 11. Ans. B

Explanation:

- APO Chairmanship assumed by: India
 - ✓ Term duration: 2025–26
 - ✓ Occasion: 67th Session of APO Governing Body Meeting
 - ✓ Host city of meeting: Jakarta, Indonesia
 - ✓ Key commitment: Advance APO Vision 2030
 - ✓ Policy focus highlighted: Expansion of Green Productivity 2.0 framework

- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ About Asian Productivity Organisation (APO):
 - Type: Intergovernmental regional organisation
 - Nature: Non-political organisation
 - Establishment year: 1961
 - Headquarters: Tokyo, Japan
 - Member economies: 21
 - Core objective: Accelerate socioeconomic development through productivity enhancement
 - India's institutional linkage:
 - ◇ Membership status: Founding member
 - ◇ National nodal body: National Productivity Council (NPC)
 - ◇ NPC status: Autonomous body
 - ◇ Administrative ministry of NPC: Ministry of Commerce and Industry
 - ◇ Departmental control: DPIIT
 - ◇ Designated APO Director for India: Secretary, DPII

Q 12. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Nirmala Devi → Art
- Bhim Singh Bhavesh → Social Work
- Hemant Kumar → Medicine
- Sushil Kumar Modi → Public Affairs
- Nirmala Devi:
 - ✓ Recognised for: Preservation of traditional Sujni embroidery
 - ✓ Region of work: Muzaffarpur
 - ✓ Contribution type: Revival and promotion of traditional textile art
- Bhim Singh Bhavesh:
 - ✓ Profession: Journalist and social activist
 - ✓ Community focus: Musahar community
 - ✓ Region of work: Bhojpur
 - ✓ Key contribution: Education and social upliftment of marginalised groups
- Hemant Kumar:
 - ✓ Specialisation: Nephrology
 - ✓ Key service: Affordable kidney care and dialysis
 - ✓ Beneficiary group: Underprivileged patients
- Sushil Kumar Modi:

- ✓ Profession: Politician
- ✓ Major position held: Deputy Chief Minister of Bihar
- ✓ Contribution area: Public administration and governance

Q 13. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Event: 38th National Games
 - ✓ Host state: Uttarakhand
 - ✓ Event duration: January 28 to February 14, 2025
 - ✓ Hosting pattern: Conducted across multiple cities in Uttarakhand
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Official mascot name: Mauli
 - ✓ Mascot inspiration: Himalayan Monal
 - ✓ Himalayan Monal status: State bird of Uttarakhand
- Statement 3 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Official medal tally basis: Number of Gold medals
 - ✓ Top team: Services Sports Control Board (SSCB)
 - ✓ Gold medals by SSCB: 68
 - ✓ Second position: Maharashtra
 - ✓ Gold medals by Maharashtra: 54
 - ✓ Common confusion: Maharashtra won highest total medals but not highest Gold medals
 - ✓ Total medals by Maharashtra: 201
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Top medal standings:
 - First position: Services Sports Control Board (SSCB)
 - Second position: Maharashtra
 - Third position: Haryana
 - ✓ Individual awards:
 - Best Female Athlete: Dhinidhi Desinghu
 - Age of athlete: 14 years
 - Total medals won: 11
 - Gold medals won: 9
 - Best Male Athlete: Srihari Nataraj
 - Achievement: Won title for the second consecutive time
 - Total medals won: 10
 - Gold medals won: 9
 - ✓ Official tagline: Sankalp Se Shikar Tak

Q 14. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Awardee: Vinod Kumar Shukla
 - ✓ State: Chhattisgarh: First recipient from state
 - ✓ Field: Hindi writer: poet, novelist, essayist
 - ✓ **Writing Style:**
 - Realism + Surrealism: depiction of ordinary life
 - ✓ Notable Works:
 - Naukar Ki Kameez: novel: film adaptation by Mani Kaul
 - Deewar Mein Ek Khirkee Rahati Thi: Sahitya Akademi Award-winning work
- Additional Facts
 - ✓ Vairamuthu
 - Award: 60th Jnanpith Award: 2026
 - Language: Tamil
 - Position: 3rd Tamil recipient: after Akilan, Jayakanthan
 - Special: First primarily for Tamil poetry
 - ✓ Kedarnath Singh
 - Award: 49th Jnanpith Award: 2013
 - Use in exams: Same language distractor
- Jnanpith Award Facts
 - ✓ Institution: Bharatiya Jnanpith Trust
 - ✓ Year: 1961
 - ✓ Eligibility:
 - ✓ Indian citizens only
 - ✓ Languages: 22 languages of 8th Schedule + English
 - ✓ English added: 2013
 - ✓ First English winner: Amitav Ghosh: 2018
- ◇ Stalactite formations
- ◇ Stalagmite formations
- ◇ Blind fish: Kandekol
- River:
 - ◇ Kanger River: flows NW → SE: central through park
- Additional Facts
 - ✓ Odisha:
 - Kolab River: forms eastern boundary
 - Recent sites:
 - ◇ Guhadandi Rock Shelter
 - ◇ Ushakothi (Badrama) Wildlife Sanctuary
 - ✓ Jharkhand:
 - Key sites:
 - ◇ Palamau Tiger Reserve
 - ◇ Sohrai-Khovar painting: GI Tag
 - ✓ Madhya Pradesh:
 - Highest number of National Parks in India
 - Recent UNESCO Tentative additions:
 - Chausath Yogini Temples: Morena
 - Palace-fortresses of the Bundelas: Orchha
 - ✓ Recent UNESCO Additions
 - Maratha Military Landscapes: Maharashtra
 - Moidams of Ahom Dynasty: Assam: World Heritage status: 2024
 - Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysala: Karnataka
 - Sun Temple: Modhera: Gujarat
 - Rock-cut Sculptures and Monuments: Tripura
 - Ancient Buddhist Site: Madhya Pradesh

Q 15. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Kanger Valley National Park
 - ✓ Also Known As: Kanger Ghati National Park
 - ✓ Location: Bastar district: Chhattisgarh
 - ✓ **Key Features**
 - Karst Topography: Extensive limestone caves
 - Major Caves:
 - ◇ Kotumsar Cave
 - ◇ Kailash Cave
 - ◇ Dandak Cave
 - Cave Features:

Q 16. Ans. A

Explanation:

- International Day for Biological Diversity (IDB)
 - ✓ Date: May 22 annually
 - ✓ 2025 Theme: Living in harmony with biodiversity
 - ✓ Purpose:
 - Mid-point marker: Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (GBF)
 - Goal: Living in harmony with nature by 2050
- CBD Facts
 - ✓ Convention: Convention on Biological Diversity

- ✓ Adoption: May 22, 1992: Nairobi Conference
- ✓ Rio Sisters:
 - CBD
 - United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change
 - United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification
- ✓ Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (GBF)
 - Adoption: 2022: COP15
 - Target: 30x30 goal:
 - Protect 30% land + oceans by 2030
- Additional Information
 - ✓ Earth Day 2025 Theme:
 - ✓ Harmony with nature and sustainable development

Q 17. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Proposing ministry: Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH)
 - ✓ Identifier name: Battery Pack Aadhaar Number (BPAN)
 - ✓ Code type: Unique 21-character alphanumeric code
 - ✓ Purpose: Ensure end-to-end lifecycle traceability of battery packs
 - ✓ Lifecycle coverage: Manufacturing to recycling or disposal
- Statement 2 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Compliance responsibility: Battery producers, manufacturers and importers
 - ✓ Consumer responsibility: Not required to assign BPAN
 - ✓ Regulatory principle followed: Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR)
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Coverage of BPAN mandate:
 - Applicable batteries: Electric Vehicle batteries
 - Applicable batteries: Industrial batteries above 2 kWh capacity
 - Excluded batteries: Small portable consumer batteries
 - Excluded batteries: Standard SLI batteries (Starting, Lighting, Ignition)
 - ✓ Global policy linkage:
 - Comparable framework: Battery

- Passport of European Union
 - Shared objective: Promote circular economy
 - Secondary use objective: Enable second-life use of EV batteries for stationary storage
- ✓ Industrial policy linkage:
 - Related scheme: Production Linked Incentive scheme for Advanced Chemistry Cells
 - PLI scheme outlay: ₹18,100 crore
 - Monitoring role: Verify domestic manufacturing of battery cells
- ✓ Data and tracking architecture:
 - Code usability: Decodable without internet access
 - Static data captured: Battery type, carbon footprint, material composition
 - Dynamic data captured: Battery health, charge-discharge cycles, thermal events

Q 18. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Largest Creditor Nation
 - ✓ Country: Germany
 - ✓ Status: World's largest creditor nation
 - ✓ Metric: Net International Investment Position (NIIP)
 - ✓ Value: ~\$3.2 trillion
- Previous Rank Holder
 - ✓ Country: Japan
 - ✓ Top Position Since: 1991
- Additional Facts
 - ✓ China
 - Forex Reserves: > \$3.3 trillion
 - Status: Major creditor
 - Limitation: Lower NIIP due to liabilities + asset valuation
 - ✓ United States
 - Status: World's largest debtor
 - Reason: Persistent trade deficit
 - High foreign investment inflows
 - ✓ France
 - Status: Lower creditor position
 - Use: EU-based distractor

Q 19. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Agri-Drone Indigenisation Hub

- ✓ Location: Chennai
- ✓ Facility: Garuda Aerospace
- ✓ Status: India's first Agri-Drone Indigenisation Hub
- ✓ Objective
 - Reduce import dependence: China
 - Focus: Local manufacturing
- ✓ Components:
 - Motors
 - Flight controllers
 - Carbon fiber frames
 - Application: Indian agricultural conditions
- Additional Information
 - ✓ Garuda Aerospace:
 - Brand Ambassador: MS Dhoni
 - ✓ Drone Rules 2021:
 - Classification: Nano to Large
 - Platform: Digital Sky
 - ✓ Linked Scheme: PLI for Drones
 - Goal: Global drone hub by 2030
 - ✓ Namo Drone Didi Scheme:
 - Target: 15,000 women SHGs

Q 20. Ans. C

Explanation:

- India Justice Report (IJR) 2025
 - ✓ Edition: 4th
 - ✓ Initiated by: Tata Trusts
 - ✓ First Published: 2019
 - ✓ Pillars:
 - Police
 - Judiciary
 - Prisons
 - Legal Aid
 - ✓ Women in Police: Top State
 - State: Bihar followed by Andhra Pradesh at 21.5% and Tamil Nadu at 20.7%.
 - Women Share (Total Police): 23.7%: Highest among 18 large/mid states
 - Women in Constabulary: 27%: Highest
 - ✓ Policy Driver
 - Reservation: 35% horizontal reservation for women
 - Year: 2016
 - Coverage: All state government jobs including police
 - ✓ Performance (IJR 2025)

- Police Pillar Rank:
 - 2022: 16th
 - 2025: 10th
- ✓ Overall Rank (Large/Mid States):
 - Top State: Karnataka

Q 21. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Light-Based Supersolid
 - ✓ Definition:
 - Exotic quantum state of matter combining:
 - Solid-like order (lattice structure)
 - Superfluid-like flow (zero friction)
 - ✓ Key Experiment
 - Medium: Photons (light)
 - System: Microscopic optical cavity (highly reflective mirrors)
 - Result: Light behaved as a single quantum entity (photon condensate)
 - ✓ Key Feature:
 - Light formed crystal-like pattern + frictionless flow simultaneously
 - ✓ Scientific Background
 - Supersolid:
 - ◇ State with both rigidity + superfluidity
 - Superfluidity:
 - ◇ Zero viscosity flow: no energy loss
 - Bose-Einstein Condensate (BEC):
 - ◇ Foundation state for supersolids
 - ◇ Ultra-cold atoms behave as single quantum system
 - Key Principle:
 - ◇ Photons normally do not interact
 - ◇ Cavity confinement + extreme cooling enabled interaction

Q 22. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ PUNCH (Polarimeter to Unify the Corona and Heliosphere)
 - ✓ Space agency: NASA
 - ✓ Mission type: Constellation mission
 - ✓ Total satellites: 4
 - ✓ Satellite size: Suitcase-sized microsatellites
 - ✓ Orbit type: Sun-synchronous Low Earth Orbit (LEO)

- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Primary objective: Study transition of solar corona into solar wind
 - ✓ Scientific focus: Track movement of solar wind from Sun's outer atmosphere
 - ✓ Key concept studied: Corona-heliosphere transition zone
 - ✓ Scientific aim: Identify the missing link between corona and solar wind formation
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Indian participation:
 - Indian institute involved: Aryabhata Research Institute of Observational Sciences (ARIES)
 - Location: Nainital
 - Administrative control: Department of Science and Technology (DST)
 - Role: Indian scientists serving as co-investigators
 - ✓ Mission architecture:
 - Total imaging systems: 4
 - One satellite payload: Narrow Field Imager (NFI) for outer corona observation
 - Three satellite payloads: Wide Field Imagers (WFI) for heliosphere observation
 - Expected output: Continuous 3D visualization of solar wind
 - ✓ Launch details:
 - Launch vehicle: SpaceX Falcon 9
 - Launch type: Secondary payload mission
 - Co-passenger mission: SPHEREx
 - SPHEREx full form: Spectro-Photometer for the History of the Universe, Epoch of Reionisation and Ices Explorer
 - ✓ Related solar missions context:
 - Comparable Indian mission: Aditya-L1
 - Aditya-L1 orbit location: Lagrange Point 1 (L1)
 - L1 distance from Earth: About 1.5 million km
 - Complementary NASA mission: Parker Solar Probe
 - Parker Solar Probe role: Direct in-situ measurements inside the solar corona
- ✓ Chairperson: Saikhom Mirabai Chanu
 - ✓ Position: Chairperson, IWLF Athletes' Commission
 - ✓ Term: 4 years
 - ✓ Vice-Chairperson: S. Sathish Kumar
 - ✓ Achievement: 2-time Commonwealth Games gold medallist
- Role of Commission
 - ✓ Organisation: Indian Weightlifting Federation
 - ✓ Purpose: Athlete representation in governance
 - ✓ Functions:
 - Athlete welfare
 - Voice in federation decisions
 - Bridge between athletes and administration
 - ✓ Mandate: IOC-aligned Athletes' Commission model
- Key facts of Saikhom Mirabai Chanu
 - ✓ **Origin: Manipur**
 - ✓ Achievements:
 - Olympic silver medal (Tokyo 2020)
 - World Championship gold (2017)
 - National record: 205 kg total (88 kg Snatch + 119 kg Clean & Jerk)
 - First Indian weightlifter Olympic silver medalist
 - Ended India's 22-year World Championship gold drought

Q 24. Ans. A

Explanation:

- State: Tripura
 - ✓ Scheme: ULLAS – Nav Bharat Saaksharta Karyakram
 - ✓ Benchmark: 95% functional literacy (age 15+)
 - ✓ **Tripura Result:**
 - Functional literacy: 95.6%
 - Status: 3rd state to achieve full functional literacy
- State Rankings (ULLAS)
 - ✓ 1st State: Mizoram
 - Literacy: 98.2% (2023–24 PLFS)
 - Status: First to achieve under ULLAS
 - ✓ 2nd State: Goa
 - Result: Near 100% functional literacy
 - Mode: Volunteer-led training

Q 23. Ans. A

Explanation:

- IWLF Athletes' Commission (2025)

- ✓ Kerala
 - Status: First total literacy state in India (1991)
 - Trap: Old literacy achievement ≠ ULLAS achievement
- ULLAS Scheme Facts
 - ✓ Full Form: Understanding of Lifelong Learning for All in Society
 - ✓ Period: 2022–2027
 - ✓ Type: Centrally Sponsored Scheme
 - ✓ Alignment: NEP 2020
 - ✓ Target Group:
 - Age 15+ non-literate individuals
 - ✓ Components:
 - Foundational literacy
 - Numeracy
 - Critical life skills: financial + digital + civic
 - ✓ Ability to use literacy in real-life functions
 - Includes:
 - ◇ Daily communication
 - ◇ Financial transactions
 - ◇ Digital access
 - ◇ Civic participation
 - ✓ Policy & Impact
 - Vision: Viksit Bharat 2047
 - Model: Volunteer-based implementation
 - Participants: Students + community volunteers
- Related Recent Achievements
 - ✓ Ladakh
 - Status: First UT full functional literacy
 - Rate: 97%
 - ✓ Himachal Pradesh
 - Status: 4th state
 - Rate: 99.3% (2025)
 - ✓ Chandigarh
 - Status: 2nd UT
 - Rate: 99.93% (2026)

Q 25. Ans. C

Explanation:

- COP 29 (Climate Summit)
 - ✓ Location: Baku, Azerbaijan
 - ✓ Tag: “Finance COP”
 - ✓ Theme :”In Solidarity for a Green World”
 - ✓ **Core Objective**
 - New climate finance framework:

- New Collective Quantified Goal (NCQG)
- COP 29 outcome:
 - ✓ Mobilisation target: at least \$300 billion/year by 2035
- Additional Information
 - ✓ COP 30 (2025):
 - Location: Belém (Amazon gateway)
 - Focus: Updated NDCs
 - Theme: People and Implementation
 - ✓ COP 28 (2023):
 - COP 28 Host: 2023 (Dubai)
 - Outcome: First global stocktake
 - Agreement: “transition away” from fossil fuels
 - ✓ COP 31 (2026):
 - Venue: Antalya
 - Dates: 9–20 November 2026
 - Host Country: Türkiye (physical hosting: Antalya)
 - Negotiation Presidency: Australia
 - Mandate: Implementation Acceleration
 - ✓ COP 32 (2027)
 - Venue: Addis Ababa
 - Host: Africa Group (UN regional rotation system)
 - Location: Capital city of Ethiopia
- COP Presidencies Troika:
 - ✓ UAE (COP 28)
 - ✓ Azerbaijan (COP 29)
 - ✓ Brazil (COP 30)

Q 26. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Ministry of Panchayati Raj did not organise the programme “Panchayat Se Parliament 2.0”
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Organiser: National Commission for Women (NCW)
 - ✓ Programme focus: Capacity building of elected women representatives
- Statement 3 is correct:
 - ✓ Organiser: Lok Sabha Secretariat
 - ✓ Venue location: Central Hall of Samvidhan Sadan (Old Parliament Building)
- Statement 4 is correct:
 - ✓ Organiser: Ministry of Tribal Affairs

- ✓ Target group: Women representatives from Scheduled Tribes (STs)
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Programme details:
 - Programme name: Panchayat Se Parliament 2.0
 - Launch month and year: January 2025
 - Venue: Central Hall, Samvidhan Sadan
 - Participants: 502 elected women representatives
 - Coverage: 22 States and Union Territories
 - Training focus: Parliamentary procedures, governance and constitutional rights
 - ✓ Commemorative linkage:
 - Occasion: 150th birth anniversary of Bhagwan Birsa Munda
 - Associated observance day: Janjatiya Gaurav Divas
 - Date of observance: November 15
 - ✓ Constitutional linkage:
 - Relevant Article: Article 243D(3)
 - Amendment introducing reservation: 73rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1992
 - Minimum reservation for women in PRIs: One-third (33%)
 - Higher reservation states: More than 20 states including Bihar
 - ✓ Programme ecosystem linkage:
 - Parent initiative: She is a Changemaker
 - Lead institution: National Commission for Women (NCW)

Q 27. Ans. B

Explanation:

- India's First Diabetes Biobank
 - ✓ Location: Chennai
 - ✓ Institute: Madras Diabetes Research Foundation
 - ✓ Support: Indian Council of Medical Research
 - ✓ Core Facility
 - Stores:
 - ◇ Blood
 - ◇ DNA
 - ◇ Serum
 - Duration: Long-term sample storage

- Scale: Thousands of diabetic patients
- ✓ Purpose: Precision medicine research
- ✓ Scientific Objective
 - Focus: Diabetes in Indian population
 - Key Study Area: Lower BMI diabetes susceptibility

● ICMR: Facts

- ✓ Full Form: Indian Council of Medical Research
- ✓ Establishment: 1911 (IRFA)
- ✓ Headquarters: New Delhi
- ✓ Role: Apex biomedical research body

● Additional Information

- ✓ Biobank: Definition
 - Biorepository: Storage of biological samples
 - Use: Medical + genetic research
 - Aim: Disease analysis + treatment development
 - Phenomenon: "Thin-Fat Indian" phenotype

Q 28. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Mission name: Mission for Cotton Productivity
 - ✓ Announcement: Union Budget 2025–26
 - ✓ Mission duration: 5 years
 - ✓ Incorrect duration mentioned: 3 years
 - ✓ Policy linkage: Supports Vision 2030 for textile sector
 - ✓ Key focus: Development of Extra Long Staple (ELS) cotton
 - ✓ Technology focus: Advanced breeding and biotechnology
- Statement 2 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Nodal department: Department of Agricultural Research and Education (DARE)
 - ✓ Administrative ministry: Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare
 - ✓ Role of Ministry of Textiles: Collaborative partner only
 - ✓ Core intervention level: Agronomic research and yield improvement
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Productivity context:
 - India global status: Largest area under cotton cultivation

- Share of global cotton area: About 40%
- India cotton productivity: About 450 kg per hectare
- Global average productivity: Above 800 kg per hectare
- Mission objective: Reduce productivity gap
- ✓ Policy framework linkage:
 - Vision framework: 5F Vision for the textile sector
 - 5F sequence:
 - ◇ Farm to Fibre
 - ◇ Fibre to Factory
 - ◇ Factory to Fashion
 - ◇ Fashion to Foreign
- ✓ Implementation ecosystem:
 - ◇ Key implementing body: ICAR
 - ◇ Specialised institute: ICAR Central Institute for Cotton Research (CICR)
 - ◇ Headquarters of CICR: Nagpur
 - ◇ Field intervention method: High-Density Planting System (HDPS)
- ✓ Branding and trade linkage:
 - Related initiative: Kasturi Cotton Bharat
 - Core objective: Develop premium branded Indian cotton
 - Import reduction goal: Reduce dependence on foreign premium cotton varieties
 - Examples of imported varieties: Egyptian Giza, American Supima
- Original focus: Civil servants (bureaucrats)
- Extension: Local self-government (Panchayats)
- ✓ Governance Context
 - Constitutional basis: 73rd Constitutional Amendment (1992)
 - Linked Schedule: 11th Schedule (29 subjects)
 - Aim: Empower Panchayati Raj Institutions

Q 30. Ans. C

Explanation:

- India's First Green Hydrogen Hub
 - ✓ Location: Pudimadaka
 - ✓ Nearby City: Visakhapatnam
 - ✓ Project Developer: NTPC Green Energy Limited
 - ✓ Status: Foundation stone laid (2026)
 - ✓ Type: Integrated Green Hydrogen Hub
 - ✓ Project Objective
 - Functions:
 - ◇ Green hydrogen production
 - ◇ Storage infrastructure
 - ◇ Export ecosystem
 - Driver: Renewable energy integration + port access
- Additional Information
 - ✓ Kochi
 - India's first Green Hydrogen plant (CIAL)
 - Pilot hydrogen hub projects
 - Status: Not the national mega-hub location
 - ✓ Mundra
 - Developer: Adani New Industries
 - Type: Private-sector green hydrogen ecosystem
 - Status: Not "foundation stone national hub"
 - ✓ Paradip
 - Projects: Green ammonia + hydrogen developments
- Mission: National Green Hydrogen Mission
 - ✓ Launch Year: 2023
 - ✓ Budget: ₹19,744 crore
 - ✓ Target: 5 MMT/year Green Hydrogen by 2030

Q 29. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Viksit Panchayat Karmayogi Initiative
 - ✓ Launch: Jitendra Singh
 - ✓ Scheme: Viksit Panchayat Karmayogi
 - ✓ Objective
 - Target group: > 3 million Panchayat representatives
 - Focus: Capacity building + professional training
 - Goal: Decentralised governance strengthening
 - Vision alignment: Viksit Bharat 2047
 - ✓ Framework Linkage
 - Parent programme: Mission Karmayogi

- ✓ Produced via electrolysis of water
- ✓ Energy Source: Renewable (solar + wind)
- ✓ Feature: Zero carbon emissions in production

Q 31. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Fiscal Health Index (FHI) 2025
 - ✓ Top State: Odisha
 - ✓ Score: 67.8
 - ✓ Rank: 1st among 18 major states
 - ✓ Core Performance Areas
 - Debt Sustainability: Strong
 - Debt Management: Strong
 - ✓ Fiscal Features:
 - Low fiscal deficit
 - High capital outlay to GSDP ratio
 - High asset-creation expenditure
 - ✓ Revenue Base:
 - High non-tax revenue (mining premiums)
 - ~21% of total revenue (one of highest in India)
- FHI: Framework
 - ✓ Assessment Pillars:
 - Tax Buoyancy
 - Revenue Mobilisation
 - Expenditure Quality
 - Fiscal Prudence
 - Debt Sustainability

Additional Information:

- Gujarat
 - ✓ Rank: 5th
 - ✓ Strength: Industrial + revenue generation
 - ✓ Weakness: Higher debt-to-GSDP ratio
- Karnataka
 - ✓ Rank: 10th
 - ✓ Category: Performer state
 - ✓ Strength: IT + service exports
 - ✓ Issue: Emerging fiscal pressure
- Bihar
 - ✓ Category: Aspirational → Performer
 - ✓ Improvement: Better deficit control + tax revenue growth
- Top 5 States (2025)
 - ✓ Odisha: 67.8
 - ✓ Chhattisgarh: 55.2
 - ✓ Goa: 53.6

- ✓ Jharkhand: 51.6
- ✓ Gujarat: 50.5

● Current Trends (2025–2026)

- ✓ Leaders: Odisha (continued dominance)
- ✓ Fastest Improvement: Jharkhand, Haryana
- ✓ Weak Performers: Punjab, West Bengal, Kerala

● Fiscal Health Index Report 2025

- ✓ Released by: NITI Aayog
- ✓ Nature: Annual publication
- ✓ Purpose: Assessment of fiscal health of Indian states

Q 32. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Estimation and Measurement of India's Digital Economy:
 - ✓ Released by: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)
 - ✓ Prepared by: Indian Council for Research on International Economic Relations (ICRIER)
 - ✓ Focus: Measurement of digital economy contribution to GDP and employment
- Key Economic Findings:
 - ✓ Contribution to GDP: 11.74% of national income in 2022–23
 - ✓ Projected Contribution: Around 20% (one-fifth) of national income by 2029–30
 - ✓ Growth Rate: Nearly twice as fast as the overall economy
 - ✓ Employment: 14.67 million workers
 - ✓ Share of Workforce: 2.55% of the total workforce in 2022–23

Q 33. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Project VISTAAR (Village Information System for Technology and Agricultural Resources)
- Nodal Agencies and Partners
 - ✓ Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare: Lead nodal ministry
 - ✓ Technical partners:
 - ✓ Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation
 - ✓ Wadhvani AI
- Core Objective
 - ✓ Agricultural resource access
 - ✓ Purpose: Bridge the information gap for small and marginal farmers

- Key Features
 - ✓ AI-driven chatbots: Provide advisory support
 - ✓ Real-time data: Used for decision support
 - ✓ Services provided:
 - Crop management advice
 - Weather forecasts
 - Market price information
 - Delivery mode: Mobile phones
 - ✓ Localization: Region-specific agricultural advisory
- Technology Integration
 - ✓ Bhashini Platform: Integrated AI language translation system
 - ✓ Function: Enables communication in native dialects
 - ✓ Outcome: Reduces language and literacy barriers
- Economic and Agricultural Impact
 - ✓ Input cost reduction: 15–20% (fertilizers, pesticides)
 - ✓ Yield improvement: Through timely pest and weather alerts
 - ✓ Precision agriculture: Data-driven farming support
- Related Schemes and Ecosystem
 - ✓ Kisan e-Mitra: AI chatbot for PM-KISAN support system
 - ✓ Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) for Agriculture: Union Budget initiative
 - ✓ Includes: Digital Crop Survey
- ✓ Delivery system: Functional Household Tap Connection (FHTC)
- Current Progress (early 2025)
 - ✓ Coverage achieved: Over 75% rural households
 - ✓ 100% coverage states/UTs:
 - Goa
 - Telangana
 - Haryana
 - Puducherry
- Nodal Ministry
 - ✓ Ministry: Ministry of Jal Shakti
 - ✓ Formation: 2019
 - ✓ Merger:
 - Ministry of Water Resources, River Development & Ganga Rejuvenation
 - Ministry of Drinking Water and Sanitation
- Key Shift in Approach
 - ✓ Shift: Infrastructure creation → Service delivery
 - ✓ Focus: Ensuring functional tap water, not just installation
- Evolution of Rural Water Supply Programmes
 - ✓ ARWSP (Accelerated Rural Water Supply Programme): 1972
 - Purpose: Basic water supply in problem villages
 - ✓ RGNDWM (Rajiv Gandhi National Drinking Water Mission): 1986
 - Focus: Technology + water quality improvement
 - ✓ Jal Jeevan Mission: 2019
 - Goal: 100% tap water connectivity (original target 2024, revised 2028)
- Global Linkage
 - ✓ SDG 6: Clean Water and Sanitation
 - ✓ UN target year: 2030
 - ✓ JJM alignment: India aims earlier domestic completion than global SDG deadline

Q 34. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM)
 - ✓ Original deadline: March 2024
 - ✓ Revised deadline: March 2028 (extended in late 2024)
 - ✓ Reason for extension: COVID-19 delays + supply chain disruptions
 - ✓ Coverage gap: Remaining ~25% rural households
 - ✓ Affected areas: Difficult terrain + contaminated water sources
- Objective (Har Ghar Jal)
 - ✓ Launch date: 15 August 2019
 - ✓ Objective: Safe drinking water to every rural household
 - ✓ Water supply norm: 55 litres per capita per day (lpcd)
- Campaign Name: “Imagine a world with more women in science”
 - ✓ Launch: Early 2024
 - ✓ Occasion: International Day of Women and Girls in Science
 - ✓ Date of observance: 11 February (annual)
 - ✓ Agency: UNESCO

Q 35. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Campaign Name: “Imagine a world with more women in science”
 - ✓ Launch: Early 2024
 - ✓ Occasion: International Day of Women and Girls in Science
 - ✓ Date of observance: 11 February (annual)
 - ✓ Agency: UNESCO

- Key Findings (Global Gender Gap in Science)
 - ✓ Women researchers globally: 33%
- Key issues:
 - ✓ Lower research funding for women
 - ✓ Lower promotion to senior positions
 - ✓ Underrepresentation in leadership roles
- UNDP: Gender Social Norms Index + Human Development Report
 - ✓ Focus: Broad development, poverty, governance
- World Bank: Women, Business and the Law report
 - ✓ Focus: Legal barriers + economic participation of women
- UNICEF: Child rights and education focus
 - ✓ Supports girls in STEM education
- ✓ Incorrect agency mentioned: NASA
- ✓ Programme full form: Project for On-Board Autonomy (PROBA)
- ✓ Mission type: Technology demonstration mission
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Launch vehicle: PSLV-C59
 - ✓ Launching agency: ISRO
 - ✓ Launch site: Satish Dhawan Space Centre (SDSC-SHAR)
 - ✓ Launch time: December 2024
 - ✓ Commercial execution arm: NewSpace India Limited (NSIL)
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Mission design:
 - Mission type: Precision formation-flying mission
 - Number of satellites: 2
 - Satellite names: Coronagraph spacecraft and Occulter spacecraft
 - Separation distance: About 144 meters
 - Control precision: Millimetre-level positional accuracy
 - Orbit type: Highly elliptical Earth orbit
 - ✓ Scientific objective:
 - Core experiment: Artificial solar eclipse creation
 - Occulter role: Blocks Sun's bright disk
 - Coronagraph role: Observes Sun's inner corona
 - Key benefit: Enables prolonged observation of solar corona
 - ✓ Comparison with the Indian mission:
 - Comparable mission: Aditya-L1
 - Aditya-L1 method: Internal coronagraph technique
 - Proba-3 method: External dual-spacecraft eclipse technique
 - ✓ Strategic significance:
 - Nature of launch: International commercial mission
 - Global implication: Demonstrates reliability of PSLV
 - Market impact: Strengthens India's commercial space launch reputation

Q 36. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Location and Physical Geography
 - ✓ Pass name: Pangsau Pass (also called Pan-Saung Pass)
 - ✓ Altitude: 3,727 feet
 - ✓ Location: Indo-Myanmar border
 - ✓ Indian state: Arunachal Pradesh
 - ✓ Nickname: "Hell Pass"
- Strategic Importance
 - ✓ Border role: India-Myanmar international border pass
- Key importance:
 - ✓ India-Myanmar border fencing project
 - ✓ Strategic frontier surveillance
- Historical Importance
 - ✓ Stilwell Road connection
 - ✓ Role: Entry point into Myanmar from India
 - ✓ World War II significance: Allied supply route
- Stilwell Road (Ledo Road):
 - ✓ Built during World War II
 - ✓ Route: Ledo (Assam) → Myanmar → Kunming (China)
 - ✓ Pangsau Pass: Entry point into Myanmar section

Q 37. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Mission name: Proba-3
 - ✓ Owning agency: European Space Agency (ESA)

Q 38. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Exercise Surya Kiran-XVIII

- ✓ Location: Saljhandi, Nepal
- ✓ Type: Bilateral military exercise
- ✓ Participants: Indian Army + Nepalese Army
- ✓ Frequency: Annual
- Objectives
 - ✓ Interoperability enhancement: Yes
 - ✓ Operational focus areas:
 - ✓ Jungle warfare
 - ✓ Counter-terrorism operations
 - ✓ Mountain warfare
 - ✓ Humanitarian Assistance and Disaster Relief (HADR)

Additional Information

- Bangladesh:
 - ✓ Relevant exercise: Sampriti
 - ✓ Focus: Counter-insurgency + command post exercises
 - ✓ Latest edition: 11th edition held in 2023–2024
- Myanmar:
 - ✓ Relevant exercise: IMBAX (India–Myanmar Army Exercise)
 - ✓ Focus: Border management + limited joint drills
 - ✓ Frequency: Less regular than Surya Kiran

Q 39. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Global Wage Report
 - ✓ Publisher: International Labour Organization (ILO)
 - ✓ Frequency: Biennial (released every 2 years)
 - ✓ Focus: Global wage trends + labour market analysis
- Key Areas
 - ✓ Gender pay gap: ~20% globally (ILO estimate)
 - ✓ Real wages: Decline in many G20 countries due to inflation
 - ✓ Nominal vs real wages:
 - Nominal wages: Pay on paper
 - Real wages: Purchasing power after inflation
- Related ILO Reports
 - ✓ World Employment and Social Outlook (WESO):
 - ✓ Tracks unemployment trends
 - ✓ Includes “jobs gap” analysis

Additional Information

- World Bank:
 - ✓ Reports: World Development Report, Global Economic Prospects
 - ✓ Focus: Poverty, income, development economics
- IMF:
 - ✓ Reports: World Economic Outlook (WEO), Global Financial Stability Report
 - ✓ Focus: Macro stability, fiscal policy, financial systems
- UNDP:
 - ✓ Reports: Human Development Report (HDR), Gender Social Norms Index
 - ✓ Focus: Health, education, standard of living

Q 40. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Project name: GenomeIndia Project
 - ✓ Funding department: Department of Biotechnology (DBT)
 - ✓ Administrative ministry: Ministry of Science and Technology
 - ✓ Project type: Pan-India genomic sequencing initiative
- Statement 2 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Primary objective: Sequence genomes of the Indian population
 - ✓ Target number of genomes: 10,000
 - ✓ Core outcome: Create Indian Reference Genome
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Project implementation framework:
 - Lead coordinating institute: Centre for Brain Research (CBR)
 - Host institution: Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru
 - Total participating institutes: 20 national institutions
 - ✓ Data generation and storage:
 - Total genomes sequenced: 10,000
 - Estimated data generated: About 8 petabytes
 - Data repository: Indian Biological Data Centre (IBDC)
 - Repository location: Faridabad
 - IBDC significance: India's first national life science data repository

- ✓ Scientific relevance:
 - Population diversity in India: Over 4,600 population groups
 - Key genetic factor: High prevalence of endogamy
 - Health relevance: Identification of rare genetic disease patterns
- ✓ Healthcare application:
 - Long-term goal: Enable precision medicine
 - Medical benefit: Development of population-specific drugs
 - Strategic importance: Reduce dependence on Western genetic databases
- ISA focus: Large-scale utility solar (not CPF model)
- ✓ Egypt
 - Projects: Benban Solar Park + COP27 host
 - Model: Bilateral renewable energy deals (not ISA CPF)
- ISA: Facts
 - ✓ Launch: COP21, 2015 (Paris)
 - ✓ Founding: India + France
 - ✓ Headquarters: Gurugram
 - ✓ **Membership:**
 - Initially Tropics of Cancer–Capricorn countries
 - Expanded (2020): All UN member states eligible

Q 41. Ans. C

Explanation:

- International Solar Alliance (ISA): Country Partnership Framework (CPF)
 - ✓ Country: Mauritius
 - ✓ Significance: First African nation to sign ISA Country Partnership Framework (CPF)
 - ✓ **Framework Objective**
 - Organisation: International Solar Alliance
 - Purpose: Accelerate renewable energy transition
 - ✓ Focus Areas:
 - Rooftop solar systems
 - Solar-powered irrigation
 - Low-interest financing mobilisation
 - Technical assistance
 - ✓ CPF Model
 - Type: Long-term solar investment framework
 - Approach: “One-stop-shop” project pipeline
 - Goal: Make solar projects bankable for global investors
- Additional Facts
 - ✓ Kenya
 - Energy strength: Geothermal + wind power
 - ISA link: Specific solar MoUs (not CPF framework)
 - ✓ South Africa
 - Focus: Just Energy Transition Partnership (JETP)

Q 42. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Initiative name: AIM4NatuRe (Accelerating Innovative Monitoring for Nature Restoration)
 - ✓ Launching organisation: Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO) of the United Nations
 - ✓ Nature: Global ecosystem restoration monitoring initiative
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Policy alignment: Target 2 of Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (GBF)
 - ✓ Core objective: Restore degraded ecosystems
 - ✓ Global restoration target: At least 30% of degraded ecosystems
 - ✓ Target year: 2030
 - ✓ Operational approach: Use advanced monitoring technology, capacity building and standardised data frameworks
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Funding and timeline:

- Total funding: About 13.5 million US dollars
- Funding country: United Kingdom
- Programme duration: Up to 2030
- Global linkage: Supports UN Decade on Ecosystem Restoration (2021–2030)
- ✓ Programme evolution:
 - Predecessor initiative: AIM4Forests
 - Earlier focus: Monitoring deforestation
 - Expanded coverage under AIM4NatuRe: Wetlands, grasslands, marine ecosystems and degraded agricultural lands
- ✓ Technology platform:
 - Core monitoring system: Framework for Ecosystem Restoration Monitoring (FERM)
 - Platform nature: Open-source monitoring tool
 - Purpose: Enable transparent national restoration reporting
- ✓ Conceptual linkage:
 - Target 2 focus: Restoration of degraded ecosystems
 - Target 3 distinction: Protection of 30% land and marine areas (30×30 target)
- ✓ Community participation feature:
 - Special monitoring approach: Indigenous-led ecosystem monitoring
 - Pilot countries: Brazil and Peru
 - Approach principle: Integrates indigenous ecological knowledge with scientific data
- Reverse Osmosis (RO)
 - Reuse model: Treated water supplied to industrial units
 - Industrial units covered: Over 1,400
 - Pipeline length: About 95 km
- ✓ Financial model:
 - Implementation model: Public-Private Partnership Hybrid Annuity Model (PPP-HAM)
- ✓ Related municipal bond milestones:
 - First modern municipal bond in India: Pune Municipal Corporation
 - Issue year: 2017
 - Purpose: 24x7 water supply project
- ✓ First public green bond by municipal body: Indore Municipal Corporation
 - Issue year: 2023
 - Project funded: 60 MW solar power plant
- ✓ Conceptual fact:
 - Green bond definition: Debt instrument used to finance environmental and climate-related projects
 - Regulatory authority in India: Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)

Q 44. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ World Press Freedom Index
 - ✓ Publishing organisation: Reporters Without Borders (RSF)
 - ✓ Organisation type: International non-profit
 - ✓ Headquarters location: Paris
 - ✓ Publication frequency: Annual
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ India's rank in 2025: 151 out of 180 countries
 - ✓ India score in 2025: 32.96
 - ✓ Rank trend: Improved from the previous year
 - ✓ India's rank in 2024: 159
 - ✓ India's rank in 2023: 161
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Total indicators used: 5
 - Political context
 - Legal framework
 - Economic context
 - Sociocultural context
 - Safety of journalists

Q 43. Ans. A

Explanation:

- First Urban Local Body to issue Green Municipal Bond: Ghaziabad Municipal Corporation
 - ✓ State: Uttar Pradesh
 - ✓ Mission linkage: Swachh Bharat Mission (Urban)
 - ✓ Amount raised: ₹150 crore
 - ✓ Project funded: Tertiary Sewage Treatment Plant (TSTP)
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Project details:
 - Treatment capacity: 40 MLD (Million Litres per Day)
 - Technology used: Microfiltration and

- ✓ Classification criteria:
 - Score below 40 category: Very serious press freedom situation
 - India category in 2025: Very serious
- ✓ Regional comparison:
 - India rank: 151
 - Nepal rank: 90
 - Maldives rank: 104
 - Sri Lanka rank: 139
 - Pakistan rank: 158
- ✓ Global standings:
 - Top-ranked country: Norway
 - Norway's achievement: Ranked first for 9 consecutive years
 - Lowest-ranked country: Eritrea
- ✓ Constitutional linkage in India:
 - Relevant Article: Article 19(1)(a)
 - Right guaranteed: Freedom of Speech and Expression
 - Judicial interpretation case: Romesh Thapar vs State of Madras, 1950.

Q 45. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana (PMMY):
 - ✓ Maximum loan limit revised to: ₹20 lakh
 - ✓ Previous maximum limit: ₹10 lakh
 - ✓ Budget announcement: Union Budget 2024–25
 - ✓ Implementation notification: October 2024
 - ✓ Target beneficiaries: Entrepreneurs with a good repayment record
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ New loan category introduced:
 - Category name: Tarun Plus
 - Loan range: ₹10 lakh to ₹20 lakh
 - Eligibility condition: Available only to borrowers who successfully repaid earlier Tarun loans
 - Collateral requirement: Collateral-free loans
 - ✓ Existing PMMY loan categories:
 - Shishu category: Loans up to ₹50,000
 - Kishore category: ₹50,001 to ₹5 lakh
 - Tarun category: ₹5 lakh to ₹10 lakh
 - ✓ Guarantee mechanism:
 - Guarantee fund: Credit Guarantee Fund for Micro Units (CGFMU)
 - Coverage: Applies to PMMY loans up

to ₹20 lakh

- ✓ Scheme basics:
 - Launch year: April 2015
 - Core objective: Funding the Unfunded
 - Target sector: Non-corporate, non-farm micro and small enterprises

Q 46. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Fiscal Health Index (FHI) 2025:
 - ✓ Releasing body: NITI Aayog
 - ✓ Total states evaluated: 18 major states
 - ✓ Bihar overall rank: 13th
 - ✓ Bihar category: Performer (third tier)
 - ✓ High-performing sub-index: Quality of Expenditure
 - ✓ Low-performing areas: Revenue Mobilisation and Fiscal Prudence
 - ✓ Structural issue: Low State Own Revenue to GSDP ratio
- Additional facts:
 - ✓ Top performing state:
 - Rank 1 state: Odisha
 - Top category name: Achievers
 - Other Achiever states: Chhattisgarh, Goa, Jharkhand
 - ✓ Other category groups:
 - Front Runner states: Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh, Telangana, Madhya Pradesh, Karnataka
 - Performer states example: Bihar, Tamil Nadu, Rajasthan, Haryana
 - Aspirant states: Punjab, Andhra Pradesh, West Bengal, Kerala
 - ✓ Index framework details:
 - Nodal institution: NITI Aayog
 - Data source: Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) audited financial data
 - ✓ Five sub-indices of FHI:
 - Quality of Expenditure: Developmental vs committed expenditure
 - Revenue Mobilisation: State revenue generation capacity
 - Fiscal Prudence: Management of fiscal and revenue deficit
 - Debt Index: Interest burden relative to revenue
 - Debt Sustainability: GSDP growth vs interest growth

Q 47. Ans. C

Explanation:

- India's first Organic Fisheries Cluster: Launched in Soreng district
 - ✓ State: Sikkim
 - ✓ Launch month and year: January 2025
 - ✓ Inaugurating authority: Union Minister of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying
 - ✓ Farming model: Organic aquaculture
 - ✓ Key principle: No use of chemicals, antibiotics or synthetic pesticides
 - ✓ Primary objective: Promote sustainable aquatic food production
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Scheme linkage:
 - Implemented under: Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY)
 - Funding support: National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)
 - Institutional model: Fisheries-based Farmer-Producer Organisations (FFPOs)
 - ✓ Production focus:
 - Target fish species: Amur carp
 - Other species: Native cold-water carps
 - Aquaculture type: High-altitude cold-water fisheries
 - ✓ State-level significance:
 - State milestone: Sikkim declared fully organic state
 - Year of declaration: 2016
 - Supporting framework: National Programme for Organic Production (NPOP)
 - ✓ Other Important Fisheries Clusters under PMMSY:
 - Pearl Fisheries Cluster: Hazaribagh, Jharkhand
 - Ornamental Fisheries Cluster: Madurai, Tamil Nadu
 - Seaweed Cluster: Lakshadweep
- ✓ Inaugurated by: Prime Minister Narendra Modi
- ✓ Location: Ganderbal district
- ✓ Union Territory: Jammu and Kashmir
- ✓ Connectivity provided: Gagangir to Sonamarg
- ✓ Altitude location: Above 8,500 feet
- ✓ Construction location: Under Thajiwas Glacier
- ✓ Primary objective: Provide all-weather connectivity to Sonamarg
- ✓ Seasonal benefit: Maintains winter access during heavy snowfall and avalanches
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Implementing details:
 - Nodal agency: National Highways and Infrastructure Development Corporation Limited (NHIDCL)
 - Project model: Engineering, Procurement and Construction (EPC)
 - Estimated project cost: ₹2,680 crore
 - ✓ Name origin: Derived from a sharp Z-shaped road alignment
 - ✓ Strategic connectivity linkage:
 - Next major tunnel: Zoji La Tunnel
 - Zoji La Tunnel length: 13.14 km
 - Connectivity corridor: Srinagar to Kargil and Leh
 - Strategic importance: Ensures year-round civilian and military movement
 - ✓ Other Important Himalayan Tunnels (High-Yield):
 - Atal Tunnel length: 9.02 km
 - ◇ Location: Rohtang Pass, Himachal Pradesh
 - Banihal-Qazigund Tunnel length: 8.45 km
 - ◇ Highway: NH-44
 - ◇ Purpose: Bypasses Jawahar Tunnel
 - Chenani-Nashri Tunnel length: 9.28 km
 - ◇ Alternate name: Dr Syama Prasad Mookerjee Tunnel
 - ◇ Highway: NH-44

Q 48. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Z-Morh Tunnel
 - ✓ Length: 6.5 km
 - ✓ Inauguration month and year: January 2025

Q 49. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Core event facts:
 - ✓ First Kho Kho World Cup

- ✓ Host country: India
- ✓ Organisers: Kho Kho Federation of India (KKFI) and International Kho Kho Federation
- ✓ Main venue: Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium
- ✓ Host city: New Delhi
- ✓ Event duration: January 13 to 19, 2025
- ✓ Men's category winner: India
- ✓ Women's category winner: India
- ✓ Runner-up in both categories: Nepal
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Participation details:
 - Total participating countries: 24
 - Continents represented: 6
 - Men's teams: 20
 - Women's teams: 19
 - ✓ Mascots:
 - Mascot names: Tara and Tejas
 - Animal represented: Chinkara
 - ✓ Sport origin:
 - Origin state of Kho Kho: Maharashtra
 - Early international exposure: Demonstration sport at the 1936 Berlin Olympics
 - Associated sports in 1936: Kabaddi and Mallakhamb
 - ✓ Institutional support:
 - Supporting body: Indian Olympic Association (IOA)
 - Estimated tournament budget: About 8 to 9 million US dollars

Q 50. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Core appointment facts:
 - ✓ Appointed official: Tuhin Kanta Pandey
 - ✓ Service batch: 1987-batch IAS
 - ✓ Position: Chairman of Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI)
 - ✓ Chairman number: 11th
 - ✓ Date of assuming office: March 1, 2025
 - ✓ Appointing authority: Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC)
 - ✓ Tenure duration: 3 years
 - ✓ Predecessor: Madhabi Puri Buch
- Background:
 - ✓ Immediate previous role: Finance Secretary of India
 - ✓ Key earlier role: Secretary, Department of

Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM)

- Additional facts:
 - ✓ About SEBI:
 - Establishment year: 1988
 - Initial status: Non-statutory body
 - Statutory status granted: January 30, 1992
 - Governing law: SEBI Act, 1992
 - Headquarters location: Mumbai
 - ✓ SEBI Board composition:
 - Chairman: 1
 - Members from the Ministry of Finance: 2
 - Member from RBI: 1
 - Other nominated members: 5
 - Whole-time member requirement: At least 3
 - ✓ Related Key Appointments:
 - Madhabi Puri Buch: 10th Chairperson of SEBI
 - ◇ Special distinction: First woman SEBI Chairperson
 - ◇ Special distinction: First private sector professional to head SEBI

Q 51. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Total participating countries: Over 100
 - ✓ Joint declaration signatories: 58 countries
 - ✓ Not all participating countries signed the declaration, especially USA and UK.
 - ✓ Official declaration title: Statement on Inclusive and Sustainable Artificial Intelligence for People and the Planet
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Event name: AI Action Summit 2025
 - ✓ Host city: Paris
 - ✓ Host country: France
 - ✓ Event dates: February 10 to 11, 2025
 - ✓ Co-chairs: Emmanuel Macron and Narendra Modi
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Major institutional outcome:
 - Initiative launched: Current AI Foundation
 - Initial funding size: About 400 million US dollars

- Key purpose: Develop AI public goods
- Public goods examples: Open-source tools, datasets and transparent AI models
- ✓ Global participation focus:
 - Strategic emphasis: Inclusion of Global South countries
 - Policy concern: Avoid biased algorithms
 - Infrastructure demand: Decentralised computing systems
- ✓ Future summit details:
 - Next summit host country: India
 - Next summit year: 2026
 - Next summit name: AI Impact Summit
- ✓ Policy and sustainability focus:
 - New initiative area: Sustainable AI systems
 - Key concern: Energy and water consumption of AI data centres
 - Coalition purpose: Measure and reduce the environmental cost of AI operations
- ✓ Final winner: India
- ✓ Runner-up: New Zealand
- ✓ Match result: India won by 4 wickets
- ✓ Final venue: Dubai International Cricket Stadium
- Statement 2 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Primary host country: Pakistan
 - ✓ Host cricket board: Pakistan Cricket Board (PCB)
 - ✓ Hosting model used: Hybrid model
 - ✓ UAE role: Neutral venue for India's matches only
 - ✓ Matches played in Pakistan: 10 out of 15
 - ✓ Pakistan host cities: Karachi, Lahore, Rawalpindi
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Tournament significance:
 - India total Champions Trophy titles: 3
 - Previous title years: 2002 (shared), 2013
 - Historic status: India became most successful team in Champions Trophy history
 - ✓ Key performers:
 - Player of the Match (Final): Rohit Sharma
 - Runs scored in final: 76
 - Player of the Tournament: Rachin Ravindra
 - ✓ Tournament performance:
 - India record: Unbeaten throughout the tournament
 - All India matches venue: Dubai, under the hybrid model

Q 52. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Australian Open 2025 (Men's Singles)
 - ✓ Winner: Jannik Sinner
 - ✓ Runner-up: Carlos Alcaraz
 - ✓ Result: Sinner defended title (2nd consecutive win)
 - ✓ Venue: Rod Laver Arena
 - ✓ Nationality of Winner: Italy
 - ✓ **Key Achievement:**
 - First Italian man to win multiple Australian Open titles
 - World No. 1 status strengthened
- Related Recent Events
 - ✓ 2024: Davis Cup 2024
 - ✓ Result: Italy retained title
 - ✓ Highlight: Sinner-led team victory
 - ✓ Achievement:
 - Sinner won both Australian Open + US Open in 2024

Q 53. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Tournament: ICC Champions Trophy 2025

Q 54. Ans. B

Explanation:

- India's First Sea Glass Bridge
 - ✓ Location: Kanyakumari
 - ✓ Inauguration: 30 December 2024
 - ✓ Occasion: Silver Jubilee of Thiruvalluvar Statue
 - ✓ Material: High-strength transparent glass
 - ✓ Environment: Marine (high salt + wind exposure)
 - ✓ Connectivity Purpose
 - Connects:
 - ◇ Vivekananda Rock Memorial
 - ◇ Thiruvalluvar Statue
 - ✓ Geographical Significance

- ✓ Location feature: Confluence of 3 water bodies
 - Bay of Bengal
 - Arabian Sea
 - Indian Ocean

Q 55. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Institution: Delhi Legislative Assembly
 - ✓ State/UT: Delhi
 - ✓ Achievement: First legislature in India to operate entirely on solar energy
 - ✓ Solar plant capacity: 500 kW rooftop solar plant
 - ✓ Commissioning time: August 2025
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ State: Madhya Pradesh
 - ✓ Achievement: Launched India's first AI-powered real-time forest alert system
 - ✓ Launch time: May 2025
 - ✓ Pilot coverage: 5 forest divisions
 - ✓ Technology used: Google Earth Engine satellite data
 - ✓ Technology used: Machine learning and mobile-based alerts
 - ✓ Primary purpose: Detect illegal logging, deforestation and land encroachment
- Statement 3 is correct:
 - ✓ State: Punjab
 - ✓ Achievement: First state to broadcast Legislative Assembly proceedings in sign language
 - ✓ Launch time: March 2025
 - ✓ Coverage of broadcast: Governor's Address and Budget Session
 - ✓ Primary objective: Improve accessibility for persons with speech and hearing disabilities
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Delhi legislative modernisation:
 - Digital initiative linked: National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA)
 - Programme objective: Paperless legislative functioning
 - Estimated annual electricity savings: About ₹1.75 crore
 - ✓ Forest governance context:
 - State with the largest forest cover area: Madhya Pradesh

- Monitoring challenge: Large forest area with limited field staff
- ✓ Legal and constitutional linkage:
 - Relevant law: Rights of Persons with Disabilities (RPWD) Act
 - Act year: 2016
 - Relevant provision: Section 40
 - Core mandate: Ensure accessibility in public communication systems

Q 56. Ans. A

Explanation:

- World Food Safety (UN)
 - ✓ June 7
 - ✓ Established by: United Nations
 - ✓ Focus:
 - Prevention of foodborne risks
 - ✓ Responsibility:
 - Governments
 - Producers
 - Consumers
 - ✓ Objective: Safe and healthy food
- World Oceans Day
 - ✓ June 8
 - ✓ Day: World Oceans Day
 - ✓ Origin: Earth Summit 1992
 - ✓ Focus:
 - Ocean conservation
 - Awareness of ocean's role
- World Day Against Child Labour
 - ✓ June 12
 - ✓ Launched by: International Labour Organization
 - ✓ Focus:
 - Elimination of child labour
 - Awareness of global exploitation
- World Blood Donor Day
 - ✓ June 14
 - ✓ Honours: Karl Landsteiner
 - ✓ Contribution: ABO blood group system discovery
 - ✓ Focus:
 - Promote voluntary blood donation

Q 57. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Portal name: NITINCAER States Economic Forum portal

- ✓ Developed by: NITI Aayog
- ✓ Collaborating institution: National Council of Applied Economic Research (NCAER)
- ✓ Launched by: Union Finance Minister
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Portal function: Centralised repository of state-level socio-economic and fiscal data
 - ✓ Data coverage period: 1990–91 to 2022–23
 - ✓ Coverage span: More than three decades
 - ✓ Data types included: Socio-economic indicators, fiscal parameters, research reports and expert commentary
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Portal structure components:
 - State Reports: Macro and fiscal profiles of 28 states
 - Data Repository: Sectoral databases across key domains
 - Fiscal and Economic Dashboard: Visual and graphical trend analysis
 - Research and Commentary: Expert and academic policy insights
 - ✓ Major data verticals covered:
 - Demography
 - Economic Structure
 - Fiscal Indicators
 - Health
 - Education
 - ✓ Strategic objective:
 - Policy aim:
 - ◇ Promote Competitive Federalism
 - ◇ Strengthen Cooperative Federalism
 - Administrative use: Enable benchmarking of state finances
 - Governance benefit: Support evidence-based fiscal planning
 - ✓ Institutional background:
 - NCAER status: India's oldest economic policy research institute
 - NCAER nature: Independent non-profit think tank
 - NITI Aayog division involved: State Finance Division
- ✓ Location: Shizuoka Prefecture
- ✓ **Key Recognition**
 - Status: World's first railway station building
 - Feature: Entire primary structure built using 3D printing technology
- Additional Information:
 - ✓ Project Details:
 - Company: Serendix
 - Collaborator: JR West Japan Group
 - Architecture Studio: Neuob
 - Old structure: Wooden station built in 1948
 - New structure: Modern 3D-printed design

Q 59. Ans. B

Explanation:

- UNESCO Memory of the World Register
 - ✓ Purpose: Preservation of documentary heritage (manuscripts, archives, texts)
 - ✓ Year: 2025 additions
 - ✓ Total India entries (International Register): 14
 - ✓ Indian Inscribed Manuscripts (2025)
 - Bhagavad Gita
 - ◇ Type: Philosophical dialogue (Krishna–Arjuna)
 - ◇ Core theme: Dharma, duty, self-realisation
 - ◇ Source: Part of Mahabharata
 - Natyashastra
 - ◇ Author: Bharata Muni
 - ◇ Domain: Performing arts
 - ◇ Scope: Drama, dance, music theory
 - ◇ Status: Oldest surviving encyclopaedic treatise on arts
- Other Facts
 - ✓ Regional Register Context (2024)
 - Ramcharitmanas
 - Panchatantra
 - Sahridayaloka-Locana
 - Register: Asia-Pacific Regional Register (May 2024)
 - ✓ Earlier International Additions (2023)
 - Abhinavagupta manuscripts
 - Non-Aligned Movement
- Additional Information
 - ✓ Memory of the World (MoW):

Q 58. Ans. D

Explanation:

- World's First 3D-Printed Station Building
 - ✓ Station: Hatsushima Station
 - ✓ Operator: East Japan Railway Company

- ✓ Established: 1992
- ✓ Aim: Prevent loss of documentary heritage
- ✓ Focus: Manuscripts + archives + rare texts

Q 60. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Scheme name: Zero Poverty – P4 initiative
 - ✓ Launching state: Andhra Pradesh
 - ✓ Chief Minister at launch: N. Chandrababu Naidu
 - ✓ Target year to achieve poverty-free status: 2029
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ P4 full form: Public-Private-People Partnership
 - ✓ Model feature: Collaboration between the government, the private sector and citizens
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Programme design:
 - Mentor group name: Margadarsis
 - Beneficiary households' name: Bangaru Kutumbam
 - Mentor source: Affluent citizens and diaspora
 - Support type: Employment, education support, healthcare funding and skill training
 - ✓ Policy linkage:
 - Long-term vision framework: Swarnandhra Vision 2047
 - Major household targets:
 - ◇ Universal tap water supply
 - ◇ LPG access
 - ◇ High-speed internet connectivity
 - ◇ Rooftop solar adoption
 - ✓ Related initiative distinction:
 - Separate campaign: Zero Poverty Uttar Pradesh Campaign
 - Launch date: October 2, 2024
 - Target approach: Identify 10 to 25 poorest families in each Gram Panchayat

- ✓ Nature: International treaty
- ✓ Primary purpose: Standardise the legal framework for financing and leasing of high-value movable assets
- ✓ Core objective: Protect the rights of creditors and lessors across countries
- ✓ Asset Categories Covered:
 - Aircraft equipment: Covered
 - Railway rolling stock: Covered
 - Space assets: Covered
 - Maritime vessels: Not covered
- Additional facts:
 - ✓ International registry system:
 - Registry name: International Registry of Mobile Assets
 - Registry headquarters: Dublin, Ireland
 - Core function: Record international financial interests in movable assets
 - ✓ India legal linkage:
 - Relevant law: Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC)
 - Relevant section: Section 14(1)
 - Provision effect: Moratorium prevents asset recovery during insolvency
 - ✓ Policy correction in India:
 - Issuing ministry: Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA)
 - Notification issued: October 2023
 - Legal basis: Section 14(3)(a) of IBC
 - Exemption granted to: Aircraft, helicopters and aircraft engines
 - ✓ Operational aviation authority:
 - Regulator: Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA)
 - Relevant rule: Rule 30(7) of Aircraft Rules, 1937
 - Key role: Deregistration of aircraft for repossession
 - ✓ Related comparative framework:
 - Cross-border insolvency model: UNCITRAL Model Law
 - Model year: 1997
 - Trade regulation frameworks: GATT and World Customs Organisation (WCO)

Q 61. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Cape Town Convention (CTC):
 - ✓ Official title: Convention on International Interests in Mobile Equipment

Q 62. Ans. B

Explanation:

- ChaSTE (Chandra's Surface Thermophysical Experiment)

- ✓ Mission: Chandrayaan-3
- ✓ Location: Onboard Vikram Lander
- ✓ Primary function: Measure thermal profile of lunar topsoil
- ✓ Historic achievement: First in-situ thermal measurement near the Moon's south pole
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ ChaSTE measurement findings:
 - Probe penetration depth: Up to 10 cm into lunar regolith
 - Surface temperature recorded: About 50°C
 - Temperature at 8 cm depth: About -10°C
 - Scientific inference: Lunar regolith acts as a strong thermal insulator
 - ✓ Other Chandrayaan-3 payload roles:
 - APXS payload: Measured elemental composition of the lunar surface
 - LIBS payload: Analysed chemical composition of lunar soil
 - ILSA payload: Recorded lunar seismic activity
 - RAMBHA-LP payload: Measured near-surface plasma density
 - SHAPE payload: Studied Earth from lunar orbit
 - ✓ Landing and mission milestones:

Landing date: August 23, 2023

 - National observance: Declared as National Space Day
 - Landing site name: Shiv Shakti Point
 - Chandrayaan-2 crash site name: Tiranga Point
 - ✓ Launch details:
 - Launch vehicle: LVM3-M4
 - Launch site: Satish Dhawan Space Centre (SDSC), Sriharikota
- Improve:
 - ◇ Transparency in Waqf property records
 - ◇ Efficiency in administration
 - ◇ Prevention of encroachment
- ✓ System Type: National digital governance platform
- ✓ Key Features
 - Centralised Database:
 - ◇ Integration of all State Waqf Boards
 - ◇ Single national property register
 - GIS Mapping:
 - ◇ Geo-tagging of Waqf properties
 - ◇ Prevents boundary manipulation + encroachment
 - Lease Management:
 - ◇ Digital leasing system
 - ◇ Tracking of tenancy + revenue flow
 - ◇ Ensures community welfare utilisation
 - Transparency:
 - ◇ Reduces benami transactions
 - ◇ Prevents illegal sale/transfer of assets
- Additional Information
 - ✓ e-NAM Portal
 - Use: Agricultural commodity trading platform
 - Purpose: Better price discovery for farmers
 - ✓ DigiLocker
 - Use: Digital document storage + verification
 - Scope: General citizen services
 - ✓ PM Gati Shakti Portal
 - Use: Integrated infrastructure planning
 - Feature: GIS-based multi-modal connectivity mapping
 - Scope: Transport + infrastructure coordination

Q 63. Ans. B

Explanation:

- UMEED Central Portal (Waqf Property Management)
 - ✓ Launched by: Ministry of Minority Affairs
 - ✓ UMEED: (Unlocking Management and Efficiency of Estates and Documentation)
 - ✓ Purpose: Centralised digital system for Waqf property management in India
 - ✓ Core Objective

Q 64. Ans. D

Explanation:

- BrahMos Aerospace Testing Facility
 - ✓ Inauguration: Rajnath Singh
 - ✓ Location: Lucknow
 - ✓ Project: BrahMos Aerospace Testing Facility + Missile Production Unit
 - ✓ Strategic Programme

- Objective: Defence self-reliance (Aatmanirbhar Bharat)
- Focus: Next-generation missile development
- ✓ Key System Developed
 - Missile: BrahMos-NG (Next Generation)
 - Type: Supersonic cruise missile
- ✓ Features:
 - Lighter design
 - Stealth capability
 - Multi-platform compatibility
 - Aircraft integration: HAL Tejas
- Additional Information
 - ✓ BrahMos system:
 - Supersonic cruise missile platform
 - Joint Indo-Russian development (BrahMos Aerospace)
 - ✓ Policy Linkage
 - Vision: Aatmanirbhar Bharat
 - Goal: Indigenous defence manufacturing
 - Focus: Export + domestic capability expansion

Q 65. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Mount Lewotobi Laki-Laki
 - ✓ Type: Active twin volcano
 - ✓ Location: Indonesia
 - ✓ Key Facts:
 - Frequent eruptions
 - Mass evacuations
 - ✓ Geographical Context:
 - Located on Pacific Ring of Fire
 - High volcanic activity zone
- Bagram Air Base
 - ✓ Type: Military base
 - ✓ Location: Afghanistan
 - ✓ Key Facts:
 - Largest US base in Afghanistan
 - Operational ~20 years
 - Significance: Strategic + historical importance
- Natanz Nuclear Facility
 - ✓ Type: Nuclear enrichment facility
 - ✓ Location: Iran
 - ✓ Key Facts:
 - Primary uranium enrichment site

- Mostly underground
- ✓ Monitoring: International Atomic Energy Agency
- ✓ Significance: Global nuclear dispute
- New Caledonia
 - ✓ Status: Special French collectivity (sui generis)
 - ✓ Region: Melanesia
 - ✓ Administered by: France

Q 66. Ans. C

Explanation:

- India's First AI-Dedicated SEZ
 - ✓ Approval State: Chhattisgarh
 - ✓ Location: Naya Raipur (Atal Nagar)
 - ✓ Type: AI Special Economic Zone (SEZ)
 - ✓ Core Shift
 - Focus: Transition to Knowledge Economy
 - Base shift: Mineral + heavy industry → AI + digital economy
 - ✓ Key Infrastructure Advantage
 - City type: Greenfield smart city
 - Feature: Pre-planned digital infrastructure
 - Includes:
 - ◇ High-speed fibre connectivity
 - ◇ Dedicated power grids
 - ✓ Policy Framework
 - Scheme: AI-First Policy (2025–2030)
 - Incentives:
 - ◇ 100% electricity duty exemption
 - ◇ Capital subsidies for AI startups
 - ◇ Support for data centres

Q 67. Ans. D

Explanation

- Guyana's Highest Civilian Award
 - ✓ Award: Order of Excellence
 - ✓ Country: Guyana
 - ✓ Recipient: Narendra Modi
 - ✓ Conferred by: Irfaan Ali
 - ✓ Key Highlights
 - Event: Historic state visit
 - Significance: First visit by Indian PM in 50+ years
 - ✓ Reason for Award:
 - Global statesmanship
 - Strengthening India–Guyana relations

- Another Award
 - ✓ Caribbean & South America Honors
 - ✓ Dominica
 - Award: Dominica Award of Honour
 - Reason: COVID-19 support + bilateral ties
 - ✓ Barbados
 - Award: Honorary Order of Freedom of Barbados
- Another Information
 - ✓ Jamaica
 - Top award: Order of Merit
 - ✓ Japan
 - Award: Grand Cordon of the Order of the Paulownia Flowers
 - ✓ Mauritius
 - Award: Grand Commander of the Order of the Star and Key of the Indian Ocean (GCSK)

Q 68. Ans. B

Explanation:

- International Centre of Films for Children and Young People (CIFEJ)
 - ✓ Elected: Jitendra Mishra
 - ✓ Position: President
 - ✓ Term: 2025–2027
 - ✓ Headquarters: Athens
- About Jitendra Mishra
 - ✓ Role: Independent filmmaker, curator
 - ✓ Festival:
 - Director: Smile International Film Festival for Children and Youth
 - Organised by: Smile Foundation
 - ✓ Notable Films:
 - I Am Kalam
 - The Last Color
 - Barefoot Empress
 - ✓ Global Role:
 - Member: Cannes Film Festival Producers Network
- Additional Information of International Centre of Films for Children and Young People (CIFEJ)
 - ✓ Founded: 1955
 - ✓ Affiliation: Under UNESCO
 - ✓ Type: Global non-profit organisation
 - ✓ Mission:
 - Promote children & youth-focused audio-visual content

Q 69. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Event: Khelo India Para Games (KIPG) 2025
 - ✓ Edition: Second edition
 - ✓ Top state: Haryana
 - ✓ Haryana medal tally: 34 Gold, 39 Silver, 31 Bronze
 - ✓ Total medals by Haryana: 104
 - ✓ Achievement: Haryana defended overall championship title
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Host city: New Delhi
 - ✓ Event duration: March 20 to 27, 2025
 - ✓ Official mascot name: Ujjwala
 - ✓ Mascot symbol: House sparrow
 - ✓ House sparrow status: State bird of Delhi
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Top Medal Tally States:
 - 1st: Haryana – 104 medals (34 Gold)
 - 2nd: Tamil Nadu – 74 medals (28 Gold)
 - 3rd: Uttar Pradesh – 64 medals (23 Gold)
 - ✓ Participation details:
 - Total athletes: Over 1,300
 - Participating units: 36 States and Union Territories
 - ✓ Sports disciplines included:
 - Para-archery
 - Para-athletics
 - Para-badminton
 - Para-powerlifting
 - Para-shooting
 - Para-table tennis
 - ✓ Venues in Delhi:
 - Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium
 - Indira Gandhi Stadium
 - Dr Karni Singh Shooting Range
 - ✓ Performance highlight:
 - Total Para National Records broken: 18
 - Records by women athletes: 12
 - Key discipline with records: Para-powerlifting

Q 70. Ans. A

Explanation:

- World Environment Day 2025
 - ✓ Date: June 5
 - ✓ Host Country: Republic of Korea
 - ✓ Theme: Ending plastic pollution
 - ✓ Campaign Hashtag: #BeatPlasticPollution
 - ✓ Slogan: Shared Challenge, Collective Action
 - ✓ Key Focus
 - Objective:
 - ◇ Global action against plastic pollution
 - ✓ Approach:
 - Circular economy model
 - ✓ Principle: Refuse, Reduce, Reuse, Recycle

Q 71. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Pair 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Book: 75 Great Revolutionaries of India
 - ✓ Author: Bhim Singh
 - ✓ Author position: Rajya Sabha MP
- Pair 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Book: Save America
 - ✓ Author: Donald J. Trump
 - ✓ Author position: 45th and 47th US President
- Pair 3 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Book: The Diary of a Cricketer's Wife: A Very Unusual Memoir
 - ✓ Correct author: Puja Pujara (Puja Pabari)
 - ✓ Identity: Wife of cricketer Cheteshwar Pujara
 - ✓ Error reason: Book not written by Cheteshwar Pujara
- Pair 4 is correct:
 - ✓ Book: Janata Ki Kahani Meri Atmakatha
 - ✓ Author: Bandaru Dattatreya
 - ✓ Author position: Governor of Haryana
- Additional Fact:
 - ✓ Why Bharat Matters:
 - Author: S. Jaishankar
 - Author position: External Affairs Minister of India
 - ✓ Breaking the Mould: Reimagining India's Economic Future:
 - Authors: Raghuram Rajan and Rohit Lamba

- ✓ Gandhi: A Life in Three Campaigns:
 - Author: M. J. Akbar
- ✓ The Miracle Makers: Indian Cricket's Greatest Epic:
 - Authors: Bharat Sundaresan and Gaurav Joshi
- ✓ Kargil: Ek Yatri Ki Jubani:
 - Author: Rishi Raj
 - Theme: Kargil War 1999
- ✓ A New Idea of India:
 - Authors: Harsh Madhusudan and Rajeev Mantri

Q 72. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Mahuadanr Wolf Sanctuary
 - ✓ State: Jharkhand
 - ✓ Status: India's first dedicated wolf sanctuary
 - ✓ Species: Indian Gray Wolf
 - ✓ Established: 1976
 - ✓ Earlier: Part of Palamau Tiger Reserve ecosystem
 - ✓ Upgrade: Dedicated wolf conservation site
 - ✓ Conservation Programme
 - Initiative: Project Wolf
 - Launch: Late 2025
 - ✓ Focus:
 - Habitat restoration
 - Species-specific conservation
 - ✓ Habitat Characteristics Type:
 - Scrubland
 - Rocky terrain
 - ✓ Reason: Suitable for open-country hunting
- Additional Information
 - ✓ Madhya Pradesh
 - Site: Nauradehi Wildlife Sanctuary
 - Note: Highest wolf population but multi-species sanctuary
 - ✓ Chhattisgarh
 - Focus: Grassland policy + wild buffalo conservation
 - Note: No dedicated wolf sanctuary
 - ✓ Odisha
 - Simlipal National Park
 - Bhitarkanika National Park
 - Species: Elephants, tigers, Olive Ridley turtles

Q 73. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Chief Guest 2025
 - ✓ Chief Guest: Prabowo Subianto
 - ✓ Country: Indonesia
 - ✓ Event: India's Republic Day Parade 2025
 - ✓ **Significance**
 - Milestone: 75 years of India-Indonesia diplomatic relations
 - ✓ Strategic Importance
 - Policy Link: Act East Policy
 - ◇ Focus Areas:
 - ◇ Maritime security
 - ◇ Defence manufacturing
 - ◇ Digital public infrastructure
- Additional Information
 - ✓ 2025: Prabowo Subianto: Indonesia
 - ✓ 2024: Emmanuel Macron: France
 - ✓ 2023: Abdel Fattah el-Sisi: Egypt

Q 74. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Facility name: Experimental Advanced Superconducting Tokamak (EAST)
 - ✓ Operating institute: Institute of Plasma Physics
 - ✓ Parent organisation: Chinese Academy of Sciences (ASIPP)
 - ✓ Reactor type: Nuclear fusion reactor
 - ✓ Nickname: Artificial Sun
 - ✓ Primary objective: Replicate the nuclear fusion process of the Sun
 - ✓ Energy goal: Develop clean and virtually limitless energy
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Location city: Hefei
 - ✓ Province: Anhui
 - ✓ Country: China
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Major scientific milestone:
 - Record achieved: Sustained high-confinement plasma mode
 - Duration achieved: 403 seconds
 - Previous temperature record: 120 million degrees Celsius
 - Comparison temperature of Sun's core: About 15 million degrees Celsius

- ✓ Fusion reaction basics:
 - Primary fuel used: Deuterium and Tritium
 - Source of deuterium: Seawater
 - Source of tritium: Produced from lithium
- ✓ Global fusion project linkage:
 - Major international project: ITER (International Thermonuclear Experimental Reactor)
 - Project location: Cadarache, France
 - Member entities: China, European Union, India, Japan, South Korea, Russia, United States
- ✓ India's role in fusion research:
 - Indian participation share in ITER: About 9%
 - Major Indian contribution: Cryostat manufacturing
 - Manufacturing partner: Larsen and Toubro
- ✓ India's domestic fusion programme:
 - Nodal institute: Institute for Plasma Research (IPR)
 - Location: Bhat, Gandhinagar, Gujarat
 - Indigenous tokamak: Aditya
 - Commissioning year of Aditya: 1989
 - Indigenous tokamak: SST-1 (Steady State Superconducting Tokamak)

Q 75. Ans. C

Explanation:

- KaWaCHaM Disaster Management System (Kerala)
 - ✓ Launch: Early 2025
 - ✓ State: Kerala
 - ✓ Agency: Kerala State Disaster Management Authority (KSDMA)
 - ✓ Type: Disaster management + early warning system
- Objectives
 - ✓ Purpose: Hyper-localised real-time disaster alerts
 - ✓ Coverage: Floods, cyclones, extreme weather events
- Delivery channels:
 - ✓ Mobile application
 - ✓ SMS gateway
- System Features

- ✓ Alert type: Real-time + location-specific warnings
- ✓ Technology: Decision Support System (DSS)
- ✓ Geospatial use: GPS-based risk zoning (Geofencing)
- ✓ Alert protocol: Common Alerting Protocol (CAP)
- Emergency Communication Feature
 - ✓ Capability: Alerts can override phone silent mode
 - ✓ Function: Emergency broadcast to affected zones
 - ✓ Targeting: Hyper-local GPS-defined risk areas

Q 76. Ans. B

Explanation:

- EmpowHER Biz – Sapno Ki Udaan
 - ✓ Launch: Late 2024
 - ✓ Sector focus: Retail sector
 - ✓ Target group: Women entrepreneurs
 - ✓ Ecosystem: MSME framework (sub-initiative)
- Objectives
 - ✓ Business transition: Home-based → Formal retail enterprises
 - ✓ Support provided:
 - ✓ Credit access
 - ✓ Digital tools
 - ✓ Market linkages
 - ✓ Enterprise formalization
- Institutional Positioning
 - ✓ NITI Aayog:
 - Associated scheme: Women Entrepreneurship Platform (WEP)
 - Role: Aggregator + partnership platform
 - Not direct retail sector scheme launcher
- NABARD:
 - ✓ Focus: Rural + agriculture-linked women empowerment
 - ✓ Key model: Self-Help Groups (SHGs)
- Ministry of Women and Child Development (WCD):
 - ✓ Key schemes:
 - Mission Shakti
 - PM Matru Vandana Yojana
 - Focus: Welfare, safety, social empowerment

- Not business/retail enterprise development

Q 77. Ans. D

Explanation:

- International Booker Prize 2025
 - ✓ Winner: Banu Mushtaq
 - ✓ Work: Heart Lamp
 - ✓ Translator: Deepa Bhashti
 - ✓ Language: Kannada → English
- Historic Achievement
 - ✓ First: Short story collection to win
 - ✓ First: Kannada work to win International Booker Prize
- Prize Details
 - ✓ Award: International Booker Prize
 - ✓ Prize Money: £50,000
 - ✓ Distribution: Author + Translator (equal split)
- About Banu Mushtaq
 - ✓ Profession: Writer, lawyer, activist
 - ✓ Movement: Bandaya Sahitya (Rebel Literature)
 - ✓ Themes:
 - Women's rights
 - Reproductive rights
 - Patriarchal structures
 - Muslim community issues
- Additional Information
 - ✓ Geetanjali Shree
 - Work: Tomb of Sand
 - Year: 2022 winner
 - ✓ Arundhati Roy
 - Work: The God of Small Things
 - Year: 1997 Booker Prize (not International Booker 2025)

Q 78. Ans. D

Explanation:

- New Bacterial Species Discovery (2026)
 - ✓ Location: Tiangong Space Station
 - ✓ Agency: China Manned Space Agency
 - ✓ Type: Newly identified bacterial species
 - ✓ Classification
 - Genus: Niallia
 - ✓ Characteristics:
 - Rod-shaped
 - Gram-positive bacteria

- ✓ Objective:
 - Monitor space microbiome
- ✓ Focus:
 - Astronaut safety
 - Equipment protection
- Additional Information
 - ✓ Space Microbiome
 - Microbial ecosystem inside spacecraft
 - ✓ Feature:
 - Acts as evolutionary pressure environment
 - Leads to mutation → new strains/species

Q 79. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Highest Civilian Award of Cyprus
 - ✓ Award: Grand Cross of the Order of Makarios III
 - ✓ Country: Cyprus
 - ✓ Recipient: Narendra Modi
 - ✓ Conferred by: Nikos Christodoulides
 - ✓ Key Significance
 - Status: Highest order of merit of Cyprus
- Historical Link
 - ✓ Namesake: Makarios III
 - ✓ Fact:
 - Co-founder of Non-Aligned Movement
 - Association: Alongside Jawaharlal Nehru
- Additional Information
 - ✓ Greece
 - Award: Grand Cross of the Order of Honour (2023)
 - ✓ Italy
 - Award: Order of Merit of the Italian Republic

Q 80. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Agriculture Infrastructure Fund (AIF)
 - ✓ Top Performing State
 - Punjab: 32,823 (1st)
 - Madhya Pradesh: 27,514
 - Maharashtra: 16,015
 - Uttar Pradesh: 14,678
 - Haryana: 10,064
- Additional Information

- ✓ Agriculture Infrastructure Fund (AIF)
 - Launch: July 2020
 - Launched by: Union Government
 - Objective
 - ◇ Strengthen:
 - ◇ Post-harvest infrastructure
 - ◇ Agriculture + horticulture supply chains
 - Financial Support:
 - ◇ Interest subvention: Yes
 - ◇ Credit guarantee: Yes
 - Eligible Beneficiaries
 - ◇ Farmers
 - ◇ Agripreneurs
 - ◇ Primary Agricultural Cooperative Societies (PACS)
 - ◇ Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs)
 - ◇ Startups
 - ◇ Public-Private Partnerships (PPPs)
 - ◇ State agencies

Q 81. Ans. D

Explanation:

- National Institute of Paragliding and Aero Sports (NIPAS)
 - ✓ Location: Bir Billing
 - ✓ Site Significance:
 - Global rank: among top paragliding sites: second to Lake Como
 - Takeoff site: Billing: 2400 m
 - Landing site: Bir: 1350 m
 - ✓ International Status:
 - Hosted: Paragliding World Cup 2015
 - Regular venue: international competitions
 - ✓ Institute Functions:
 - Training
 - Pilot courses: beginner to advanced
 - ✓ Certification:
 - Standard certification for instructors
 - ✓ Economic Impact:
 - Goal: make Himachal Pradesh a paragliding hub
 - Boost: adventure tourism: local employment
- Key Facts:
 - ✓ Unique: first national-level institute for aero sports

- ✓ Other states: Uttarakhand: Sikkim: paragliding sites present but no national institute

Q 82. Ans. A

Explanation:

- 9th Capacity Building Programme for Sri Lankan Civil Servants
 - ✓ Location: Mussoorie
 - ✓ Venue: Lal Bahadur Shastri National Academy of Administration
 - ✓ Organiser: National Centre for Good Governance (NCGG)
 - ✓ Objective:
 - Capacity building of Sri Lankan officers
 - Exposure to India's governance models
 - ✓ Key Themes:
 - Digital Governance:
 - ◇ Digital India
 - ◇ Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT): Aadhaar integration
 - Public Grievance:
 - ◇ CPGRAMS system
 - Infrastructure:
 - ◇ PM Gati Shakti
 - Field Visit:
 - ◇ New Delhi
 - ◇ Visit: Pradhanmantri Sangrahalaya
 - Key Facts:
 - ✓ Part of India–Sri Lanka MoU
 - ✓ NCGG trained: 1000+ Sri Lankan officers
 - ✓ Other countries: Maldives, Bangladesh, African nations
 - ✓ Policy linkage: Neighbourhood First policy

Q 83. Ans: A

Explanation:

- Operation Sindhu
 - ✓ Purpose:
 - Evacuation of Indians from Iran–Israel conflict
 - ✓ Key Features:
 - Scale:
 - ◇ Evacuated: 15,000+ Indians
 - ◇ Duration: ~3 weeks
 - Air Operations:
 - ◇ Aircraft: IAF C-17 Globemaster
 - ◇ Support: chartered commercial flights

- Safe Corridor:
 - ◇ Humanitarian windows were negotiated with Tehran and Tel Aviv
 - ◇ Purpose: safe landing and take-off
- Transit Hubs:
 - ◇ Dubai
 - ◇ Muscat
- Naval Support:
 - ◇ INS Vikrant
 - ◇ Location: North Arabian Sea
- ✓ Significance:
 - Sindhu: reference to the Indus River
- Other Evacuation Operations:
 - ✓ Operation Ajay: 2023: evacuation from Israel conflict
 - ✓ Operation Ganga: 2022: evacuation from Ukraine
 - ✓ Operation Kaveri: 2023: evacuation from Sudan
- Key Facts:
 - ✓ Agency: Ministry of External Affairs (MEA)
 - ✓ Complexity: coordination with adversarial nations
 - ✓ Mode: air and potential sea evacuation

Q 84. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Philadelphi (Philadelphia) Corridor
 - ✓ Location: Along entire Gaza Strip–Egypt border
 - ✓ Length: ~14 km
 - ✓ Region: Rafah border area
 - ✓ Significance: Gaza's only non-Israel land border
- Strategic Importance
 - ✓ Function: Security buffer zone
 - ✓ Key role: Controls movement between Gaza and Egypt (Sinai region)
 - ✓ Conflict relevance: Major flashpoint in Israel–Palestine conflict (2024–2025)

Additional Information

- Israel–Lebanon border:
 - ✓ Defined by UN “Blue Line” (2000)
 - ✓ Conflict zone involving Hezbollah
- Israel–Jordan border:
 - ✓ Based on 1994 Israel–Jordan Peace Treaty
 - ✓ Includes Jordan Valley + Arava region

- West Bank–Jordan border:
 - ✓ Managed through Jordan Valley + Allenby/ King Hussein Bridge area
 - ✓ Distinct geopolitical structure
- Location: New Delhi
 - Achievement: Developed gene-edited rice varieties
 - Example varieties: Gene-edited Pusa Basmati strains

Q 85. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Sher-e-Kashmir University of Agricultural Sciences and Technology (SKUAST)
 - ✓ Location: Srinagar
 - ✓ Achievement: Developed India's first gene-edited sheep
 - ✓ Technology used: CRISPR-Cas9 gene editing
 - ✓ Target gene: Myostatin (MSTN) gene
 - ✓ Result achieved: About 30% increase in muscle mass
 - ✓ Biotechnology category: Gene-edited livestock
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Gene-editing classification:
 - Type of organism: Non-transgenic
 - Reason: No foreign DNA introduced
 - Applicable regulatory guideline: MoEFCC gene-editing guidelines
 - Guideline year: 2022
 - Exempted categories: SDN-1 and SDN-2 gene-edited organisms
 - ✓ Previous milestone by same institute:
 - Animal cloned: Pashmina goat
 - ✓ Clone name: Noori
 - ✓ Achievement year: 2012
 - ✓ Other Important Animal Biotechnology Milestones (High-Yield):
 - Institute: National Dairy Research Institute (NDRI)
 - Location: Karnal, Haryana
 - Achievement: World's first cloned buffalo
 - Clone name: Samrupa
 - Achievement year: 2009
 - ✓ Subsequent cloned buffalo:
 - Clone name: Garima
 - ✓ Recent cloning milestone:
 - Animal cloned: Gir female calf
 - Clone name: Ganga
 - Achievement year: 2023
 - ✓ Related crop gene-editing milestone:
 - Institute: Indian Agricultural Research Institute (IARI)

Q 86. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Kashish Chaudhary
 - ✓ Location: Balochistan
 - ✓ Achievement:
 - First Hindu woman: Assistant Commissioner
 - ✓ Selection:
 - Exam: Balochistan Public Service Commission (BPSC)
 - Age: 25 years
- Key Facts:
 - ✓ Significance: women's empowerment
 - ✓ minority representation
 - ✓ Region context: socially conservative and conflict-prone area

Q 87. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Chenab Bridge
 - ✓ Location: Jammu and Kashmir
 - ✓ River: Chenab River
 - ✓ Record:
 - The highest railway arch bridge in the world
 - Height: 359 m (1178 ft) above riverbed
 - ✓ Comparison:
 - ~35 m taller than Eiffel Tower
 - ✓ Project:
 - Part of Udhampur–Srinagar–Baramulla Rail Link: USBRL
 - Purpose: Connect Kashmir Valley to Indian railway network
- Other Bridges:
 - ✓ Bogibeel Bridge:
 - India's longest rail-cum-road bridge
 - River: Brahmaputra
 - ✓ Bhupen Hazarika Bridge:
 - India's longest bridge over water
 - Type: Road bridge
 - ✓ Digha–Sonpur Bridge:
 - Rail-cum-road bridge
 - River: Ganges

- Key Facts:
 - ✓ Height: 359 m: Highest railway arch bridge globally
 - ✓ Strategic link: Kashmir rail connectivity
 - ✓ Extreme resistance: Blast + seismic + high wind

Q 88. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Compensation Revision:
 - ✓ Earlier amount: ₹11 lakh
 - ✓ Revised amount: ₹50 lakh
 - ✓ Approved by: Cabinet chaired by Nitish Kumar
- Applicability:
 - ✓ Armed Forces personnel
 - ✓ Central Armed Police Forces personnel
 - ✓ Situations: internal security: border skirmishes: counter-insurgency
- Key Benefits:
 - ✓ Government Job:
 - 1 family member: Group C or Group D: compassionate grounds
 - ✓ Education Support:
 - Children's education: up to graduation
 - ✓ Memorials:
 - Statue installation
 - Naming: school or road
- Key Facts:
 - ✓ Purpose: financial security for Next of Kin (NoK)
 - ✓ Aligned with: other states' enhanced compensation policies

Q 89. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Khelo India Youth Games 2024
 - ✓ Achievement:
 - Alka Singh: Gold medal: Girls Shot Put
 - State: Bihar
 - ✓ Performance Details:
 - Winning distance: 14.12 m
 - Technique: Glide technique
- Key Facts:
 - ✓ Rare gold for Bihar: technical field event
 - ✓ Competition: strong states: Haryana: Punjab
 - ✓ Outcome: won in final rounds

Q 90. Ans. B

Explanation:

- 10th Governing Council meeting of NITI Aayog
 - ✓ Bihar represented by Samrat Chaudhary
 - ✓ Nitish Kumar: absent
 - ✓ Key Demands by Bihar:
 - Special Status:
 - ◇ Demand: Special Category Status or Special Financial Package
 - Flood Management:
 - ◇ Demand: High dam in Nepal
 - ◇ Purpose: control North Bihar floods
 - Industrial Incentives:
 - ◇ Focus: ethanol industry
 - ◇ Focus: food processing
 - Infrastructure:
 - ◇ Demand: expressways expansion
 - ◇ Demand: airport network expansion

Q 91. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Mashal Initiative (Bihar)
 - ✓ Launched: Bihar Government
 - ✓ Nature: Sports talent hunt
 - ✓ Claim: World's largest sports talent hunt
 - ✓ Objective:
 - Identify and nurture grassroots sports talent
 - Build a pipeline for Olympic and international athletes
- Key Features:
 - ✓ Massive Scale:
 - Target age: 8–14 years
 - Coverage: ~75,000 schools
 - Reach: Millions of children
 - ✓ Scientific Testing:
 - Method: Battery of Tests
 - Parameters: Speed, agility, power, endurance
 - Purpose: Identify sport-specific aptitude
 - ✓ Tiered Selection:
 - Levels:
 - ◇ School → Block → District → State
 - ✓ Digital Tracking:
 - Tool: Sports ID
 - Purpose: Track physical growth and performance over years

Q 92. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Atal Pension Yojana (APY)
 - ✓ Ranking (Total Enrolments)
 - 1st: Uttar Pradesh : 1.17+ crore
 - 2nd: Maharashtra
 - 3rd: Bihar : 63,59,916
 - 4th: West Bengal
 - ✓ Bihar Performance
 - Rank: 3rd
 - FY 2024–25 Achievement:
 - ◇ Target achieved: 175%
 - State Level Bankers' Committees SLBC Ranking (Target Achievement):
 - ◇ 2nd position
 - ◇ Top SLBC: Jharkhand : 184%
- Additional Information
 - ✓ Atal Pension Yojana (APY)
 - Launch Year: 2015
 - Launched by: Government of India
 - Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Finance
 - Regulator: PFRDA
 - Target Group:
 - ◇ Unorganised sector workers
 - ◇ Age eligibility: 18–40 years
 - Pension Benefits:
 - ◇ Minimum guaranteed pension: 1000 to 5000 per month
 - ◇ Pension starts at age: 60 years
- ✓ Observance date: May 21
- ✓ Purpose: Mark the death anniversary of former Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi
- ✓ Year of assassination: 1991
- ✓ Location of assassination: Sriperumbudur
- ✓ State: Tamil Nadu
- ✓ National practice: Anti-terrorism pledge administered in government institutions
- National Technology Day: May 11
 - ✓ Purpose: Commemorate Pokhran-II nuclear tests
 - ✓ Year of nuclear tests: 1998
 - ✓ Operation name: Operation Shakti
 - ✓ Location of tests: Pokhran
 - ✓ State: Rajasthan
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Migratory birds and Bihar relevance:
 - Ramsar site in Bihar: Kanwar Lake (Kabartal)
 - Location: Begusarai district
 - Year designated Ramsar site: 2020
 - Major flyway: Central Asian Flyway
 - ✓ Bird conservation in Bihar:
 - Bird sanctuary: Nagi-Nakti Bird Sanctuary
 - Location: Jamui district
 - State-level bird festival: Kalrav
 - First organised year: 2021
 - ✓ Major nuclear milestones linked to May:
 - First nuclear test in India: Smiling Buddha
 - Date: May 18, 1974
 - Location: Pokhran, Rajasthan
 - ✓ Other achievements on May 11, 1998:
 - Aircraft milestone: Maiden flight of Hansa-3
 - Missile milestone: Successful testing of the Trishul surface-to-air missile
 - ✓ Tobacco-related public health data:
 - Survey reference: NFHS-5
 - Tobacco use among men in Bihar: 48.8%
 - Tobacco use among women in Bihar: 5.0%
 - ✓ State-level tobacco control measure:
 - Ban introduced: Pan masala containing magnesium carbonate and tobacco
 - State implementing ban: Bihar
 - Initial implementation period: Around 2019–2020

Q 93. Ans. A

Explanation:

- World Migratory Bird Day: May 10 and October 11
 - ✓ Observance pattern: Second Saturday of May and October
 - ✓ Nature of observance: Global environmental awareness event
 - ✓ Theme for 2025: Insects
 - ✓ Theme focus: Impact of declining insect populations on migratory birds
- World No Tobacco Day: May 31
 - ✓ Established by: World Health Organisation (WHO)
 - ✓ Year of establishment: 1987
 - ✓ Primary objective: Raise awareness about the harmful effects of tobacco use
- National Anti-Terrorism Day: May 21

- ✓ WHO tobacco control recognition:
 - Award received by: Jharkhand
 - Award name: World No Tobacco Day Award
 - Year received: 2022

- Home city: Lucknow
- State: Uttar Pradesh
- Selection status: One of the original shortlisted Gaganyaan astronauts

Q 94. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Mission name: Axiom-4 (Ax-4)
 - ✓ Launch site: Launch Complex-39A
 - ✓ Space centre: Kennedy Space Center
 - ✓ Location: Florida, United States
 - ✓ Launch vehicle: SpaceX Falcon 9 rocket
 - ✓ Crew spacecraft: Dragon spacecraft
- Statement 2 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Total crew members: 4
 - ✓ Indian astronaut selected: Shubhanshu Shukla
 - ✓ Rank: Group Captain (Indian Air Force)
 - ✓ Role in mission: Pilot
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Complete crew composition:
 - Commander: Peggy Whitson
 - Pilot: Shubhanshu Shukla
 - Mission Specialist: Tibor Kapu
 - Mission Specialist: Sławosz Uznański-Wiśniewski
 - Backup astronaut from India:
 - ◇ Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair
 - Training details:
 - ◇ Training location: NASA Johnson Space Centre, USA
 - ✓ India-US cooperation framework:
 - Framework name: Initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology (iCET)
 - ✓ Link with India's human spaceflight programme:
 - Associated mission: Gaganyaan
 - Purpose: Gain experience in ISS operations and microgravity experiments
 - ✓ Mission objectives:
 - Total experiments planned: About 25
 - Focus areas: Human physiology and industrial applications in microgravity
 - ✓ Personal background of Shubhanshu Shukla:
 - Service: Indian Air Force

Q 95. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ System name: Bhargavastra
 - ✓ System type: Counter-drone (C-UAS) system
 - ✓ Developer: Solar Defence and Aerospace Limited (SDAL)
 - ✓ Parent company: Solar Industries India Limited
 - ✓ Headquarters of parent company: Nagpur
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Target threats: Small drones and drone swarms
 - ✓ Detection range: 6 to 10 km
 - ✓ Engagement (kill) range: Up to 2.5 km
 - ✓ Operational method: Hard-kill destruction of aerial targets
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Development background:
 - Development mode: Indigenous initiative without formal military Request for Proposal (RFP)
 - Strategic inspiration: Modern drone warfare conflicts such as the Ukraine-Russia war and the Nagorno-Karabakh conflict
 - ✓ Kill mechanism architecture:
 - Tier 1 weapon: Unguided micro-rockets
 - ◇ Primary use: Saturation attack against drone swarms
 - ◇ Approximate lethal radius: About 20 meters
 - Tier 2 weapon: Guided micro-missiles
 - ◇ Primary use: Precision targeting of individual drones
 - ✓ Launcher capability:
 - Firing mode: Salvo mode
 - Maximum munitions fired in quick succession: More than 64
 - ✓ Mobility platform:
 - Vehicle class: 7.5-ton all-terrain vehicle
 - Operational suitability: Plains, deserts, and high-altitude regions above 5,000 meters

- ✓ Network integration capability:
 - Compatible systems: Akashteer
 - Additional integration: Integrated Air Command and Control System (IACCS)
- ✓ Testing location:
 - Primary trial site: Seaward Firing Range
 - Location: Gopalpur
 - State: Odisha
- ✓ Related defence systems from the same group:
 - Loitering munition: Nagastra-1
- ✓ Rocket system association:
 - System linked: Pinaka Multi-Barrel Rocket Launcher
 - Role of Solar Industries: Private manufacturer of Pinaka rockets
- ✓ Other weapon development:
 - Thermobaric weapon series: Maheshwarastra

Q 96. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Telangana Scheduled Castes (Rationalisation of Reservations) Act, 2025
 - ✓ First state: Operationalised SC sub-classification
- Objective:
 - ✓ Equitable distribution of 15% SC reservation
 - ✓ Sectors: Education, Employment
- SC Division (56 sub-castes):
 - ✓ Group I:
 - Reservation: 1%
 - Sub-castes: 15
 - Status: Most socially and educationally disadvantaged
 - ✓ Group II:
 - Reservation: 9%
 - Sub-castes: 18
 - Status: Moderately benefited
 - ✓ Group III:
 - Reservation: 5%
 - Sub-castes: 26
 - Status: Significantly benefited
- Key Facts:
 - ✓ SC reservation: 15%
 - ✓ Telangana: First to implement post-2024 verdict
 - ✓ Legal shift: From “homogeneous group” → “permissible sub-classification”

Q 97. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Collateral-free Agriculture Loan Limit (RBI)
 - ✓ Revised Limit:
 - ₹1.6 lakh → ₹2 lakh: Increased in late 2024
 - Purpose: Improve credit access for small and marginal farmers
 - ✓ Reason for Revision:
 - Rising Input Costs:
 - ◇ Seeds, fertilisers, and diesel prices increased
 - ◇ ₹1.6 lakh is insufficient for cultivation
 - ✓ Key Features (Kisan Credit Card: KCC):
 - Interest Subvention:
 - 2% per annum
 - ✓ Prompt Repayment Incentive:
 - Additional 3%
 - Effective interest rate: 4%
 - ✓ Coverage:
 - Crop cultivation
 - Post-harvest expenses
 - Produce marketing
 - Farm asset maintenance

Q 98. Ans. C

Explanation:

- First Woman ADC to President of India
 - ✓ Major Yashasvi Solankee
 - ✓ Position: Aide-de-Camp (ADC) to President of India
 - ✓ Appointment: December 2024
 - ✓ Appointed by: President Droupadi Murmu
 - ✓ Service: Indian Army
 - ✓ Corps: Military Intelligence
- Historic Significance
 - ✓ First woman ADC to the President
- Role of ADC
 - ✓ Definition: Personal assistant to Head of State
 - ✓ Authority: President = Supreme Commander of Armed Forces
- Responsibilities:
 - ✓ Coordinate official ceremonies
 - ✓ Manage protocol + schedules
 - ✓ Assist during state events (e.g., Republic Day)

Q 99. Ans. D

Explanation:

- India's First Green Hydrogen Refuelling Station
 - ✓ Location: Leh, Ladakh
 - ✓ Executed by: Amara Raja Infra
 - ✓ For: NTPC
 - ✓ Project: Green hydrogen mobility
- Production Details
 - ✓ Capacity: 80 kg hydrogen per day
 - ✓ Power source: 1.7 MW solar plant
 - ✓ Type: Fully green hydrogen
- Engineering Features
 - ✓ Altitude: 3,400 meters
 - ✓ Status: World's highest green hydrogen mobility project
 - ✓ Conditions: Operates in low-density air + extreme cold
 - ✓ Temperature tolerance: Up to -25°C
- Policy Linkage
 - ✓ Mission: National Green Hydrogen Mission
 - ✓ Goal: Clean energy transition + emission-free mobility

Q 100. Ans. D

Explanation:

- India Justice Report 2025
- State: Bihar
- Rank: 13th (out of 18 large + mid-sized states)
- Previous rank (2022): 16th
- Key Improvements
 - ✓ Police diversity:
 - Women share: 23.7% (highest among large states)
 - Constabulary women: 27%
 - Police pillar rank: 10th (from 16th in 2022)
 - ✓ Legal aid:
 - Pillar rank: 12th (from 16th)
 - Indicator: Improved legal assistance reach
 - ✓ Judiciary pillar rank: 15th
 - ✓ Prisons:
 - ✓ Facility: 100% jails with video conferencing
 - ✓ Issue: Staff + medical vacancies
 - ✓ Prison rank: 12th
- Key facts:
 - ✓ Report pillars: Police, Judiciary, Prisons, Legal Aid

- ✓ Trend: Improvement in diversity + access
- ✓ Concern: Structural inefficiency + funding gaps

Q 101. Ans. C

Explanation:

- 20th Asian Games
 - ✓ Host country: Japan
 - ✓ Host cities: Aichi Prefecture + Nagoya
 - ✓ Official name: Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games
- Key Details
 - ✓ Main venue: Mizuho Athletics Stadium (Nagoya)
 - ✓ Motto: "Imagine One Asia"
- Future & Recent Hosts
 - ✓ 19th Asian Games hosted by Hangzhou, China
 - ✓ 21st Asian Games hosted by Doha, Qatar
- Sustainability Focus
 - ✓ Approach: Use of existing infrastructure
 - ✓ Objective: Reduce cost + environmental impact
- Key Facts
 - ✓ Governing body: Olympic Council of Asia (OCA)
 - ✓ Nature: Multi-sport continental event
 - ✓ Significance: Third hosting by Japan

Q 102. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Vijay Hazare Trophy 2024–25
 - ✓ Winner: Karnataka
 - ✓ Runner-up: Vidarbha
 - ✓ Final date: 18 January 2025
 - ✓ Venue: Kotambi Stadium, Vadodara, Gujarat
 - ✓ Title count (Karnataka): 5th
- Final Match Summary
 - ✓ Karnataka score: 348/6 (50 overs)
 - ✓ Vidarbha score: 312/10 (48.2 overs)
 - ✓ Result: Karnataka won by 36 runs
- Awards
 - ✓ Player of the Match: Smaran Ravichandran
 - ✓ Performance: 101 runs (92 balls)
 - ✓ Player of the Series: Karun Nair (Vidarbha)
 - ✓ Total runs: 779
- Key Performances
 - ✓ Karnataka:

- Smaran Ravichandran: 101
- Abhinav Manohar: 79 (42 balls, 10 sixes)
- Krishnan Shrijith: 78
- ✓ Vidarbha:
 - Dhruv Shorey: 110

Q 103. Ans. D

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Engine type: Hydrogen-powered train engine
 - ✓ Engine power developed by India: 1,200 horsepower (HP)
 - ✓ Global comparison range: Most hydrogen trains globally operate in 500–600 HP range
 - ✓ Significance: India's hydrogen engine is among the most powerful in its category
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Pilot route selected: Jind–Sonipat section
 - ✓ Railway zone: Northern Railway
 - ✓ State: Haryana
 - ✓ Route length: 89 km
 - ✓ Purpose: Pilot testing before wider national deployment
- Statement 3 is correct:
 - ✓ India's expected global position: Fifth country to operate hydrogen-powered trains
 - ✓ Countries already operating hydrogen trains:
 - Germany
 - France
 - China
 - Sweden
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Hydrogen for Heritage initiative:
 - Mission name: Hydrogen for Heritage
 - Launch year: 2023
 - Total hydrogen trains planned: 35
 - Target routes: Heritage and hill railways
 - Examples of targeted routes: Kalka–Shimla, Darjeeling Himalayan Railway
 - ✓ Project cost details:
 - Total allocation for trains: ₹2,800 crore
 - Infrastructure allocation: ₹600 crore
 - Estimated cost per hydrogen train: About ₹80 crore
 - Estimated infrastructure cost per route: About ₹70 crore

- ✓ Hydrogen production facility:
 - Plant location: Jind
 - State: Haryana
 - Electrolyser capacity: 1 MW
 - Electrolyser type: Polymer Electrolyte Membrane (PEM)
 - Daily hydrogen production capacity: About 420–430 kg
- ✓ Technical development partners:
 - Coach manufacturer: Integral Coach Factory (ICF), Chennai
 - Design agency: Research, Design and Standards Organisation (RDSO), Lucknow
- ✓ Operational specifications:
 - Total coaches per train: 10
 - Driving Power Cars: 2
 - Passenger coaches: 8
 - Passenger capacity: About 2,600 passengers
 - Maximum speed: About 110 km per hour
- ✓ Environmental significance:
 - Energy mechanism: Hydrogen fuel cell technology
 - Main output products: Electricity, water vapour, heat
 - Carbon emission status: Zero carbon dioxide emission at the point of use
- ✓ Strategic target of Indian Railways:
 - Long-term goal: Net-zero carbon emissions
 - Target year: 2030

Q 104. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Bihar's first Dinosaur Park
 - ✓ Location: Rajgir, Nalanda district
 - ✓ Site: Near Nature Safari complex
 - ✓ Area: 4.5 hectares
 - ✓ Estimated cost: ₹22 crore
 - ✓ Developed by: Bihar Forest Department
- Key Features
 - ✓ Life-sized dinosaurs:
 - Type: Realistic models
 - ✓ Animatronics:
 - Technology: AI + sensor-based
 - Features: Movement + interactive response

- Themed Zones
 - ✓ Fossil digging zone:
 - Activity: Simulated excavation experience
 - ✓ T-Rex zone:
 - Focus: Predator exhibit
 - ✓ Artificial volcano:
 - Purpose: Prehistoric environment simulation
- Objective
 - ✓ Type: Eco-tourism + educational park
 - ✓ Goal: Immersive prehistoric experience
- Key Facts
 - ✓ Target audience: Tourists + students
 - ✓ Location advantage: Part of the Nature Safari tourism circuit
 - ✓ Significance: First dinosaur park in Bihar

Q 105. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Dr. V. Narayanan
 - ✓ Position: 11th Chairman, ISRO
 - ✓ Additional role: Secretary, Department of Space (DoS)
 - ✓ Predecessor: S. Somanath
- Key Contributions
 - ✓ Cryogenic engine development:
 - ✓ GSLV Mk-II
 - ✓ LVM3 (GSLV Mk-III)
- Mission involvement:
 - ✓ Chandrayaan-2
 - ✓ Chandrayaan-3
 - ✓ Aditya-L1
- Strategic Roadmap (2025–2027)
 - ✓ Gaganyaan Mission:
 - Focus: Human-rated launch vehicle certification
 - ✓ Chandrayaan-4:
 - Objective: Lunar sample-return mission
 - ✓ Bhartiya Antariksh Station (BAS):
 - Plan: Launch initial modules of space station
 - ✓ NGLV Programme:
 - Rocket: “Soorya”
 - Feature: Partially reusable
 - Capability: Heavy payload launch

Q 106. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Index name: Travel and Tourism Development Index (TTDI)
 - ✓ Incorrect organization mentioned: UN World Tourism Organization (UNWTO)
 - ✓ Correct publishing body: World Economic Forum (WEF)
 - ✓ Report released by UNWTO: World Tourism Barometer
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Index edition: TTDI 2024
 - ✓ India's rank: 39th
 - ✓ Total countries ranked: 119
 - ✓ India's overall score: 4.25
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Methodology revision fact:
 - Earlier reported India rank (2021): 54th
 - Recalculated India rank (2021 methodology adjusted): 38th
 - India's change from adjusted 2021 to 2024: Decline by 1 rank (38th to 39th)
 - ✓ Top 5 countries in TTDI 2024:
 - 1st: United States
 - Score: 5.24
 - 2nd: Spain
 - 3rd: Japan
 - 4th: France
 - 5th: Australia
 - ✓ India's strongest performance areas:
 - Natural Resources ranking: 6th globally
 - Cultural Resources ranking: 9th globally
 - Non-Leisure Resources ranking: 9th globally
 - Price Competitiveness ranking: 18th globally
 - ✓ Regional performance:
 - Highest-ranked country in South Asia: India
 - Top performer among lower-middle-income economies: India
 - ✓ Lowest-ranked countries:
 - 118th: Sierra Leone
 - 119th: Mali
 - ✓ Institutional collaboration:
 - Report prepared by: World Economic Forum
 - Collaborating institution: University of Surrey, United Kingdom

- ✓ Bihar tourism facts:
 - Foreign Tourist Arrivals (2023–24): About 5.45 lakh
 - Top source countries for Bihar tourists: Vietnam, Thailand, Nepal
- ✓ Swadesh Darshan 2.0 sites in Bihar:
 - Gaya
 - Nalanda
- ✓ Ramayana Circuit sites in Bihar:
 - Buxar
 - Ahirauli
 - Sitamarhi
- ✓ Release: Late 2024
- ✓ Type: First comprehensive global freshwater species assessment
- ✓ Taxa covered:
 - Fish
 - Mollusks
 - Dragonflies
 - Crabs
 - Aquatic plants
- Key Findings
 - ✓ Freshwater species at risk: 25% (global average)
 - ✓ Major threats:
 - ✓ Climate change
 - ✓ Pollution
 - ✓ Invasive species

Q 107. Ans. A

Explanation:

- International Buyer-Seller Conference
 - ✓ Location: Patna, Bihar
 - ✓ Venue: Samrat Ashok Convention Centre
 - ✓ Organised by: Government of Bihar + APEDA
- Objective
 - ✓ Purpose: Connect local producers with global buyers
 - ✓ Goal: Increase farmer + MSME income
 - ✓ Approach: Reduce role of middlemen
- Focus Sectors
 - ✓ Makhana (Fox Nuts):
 - Bihar share: ~90% of global production
 - ✓ Shahi Litchi:
 - Region: Muzaffarpur
 - Focus: Seasonal export potential
 - ✓ Handicrafts:
 - Madhubani paintings
 - Sikki grass products
 - Bhagalpuri silk
- Location Significance
 - ✓ City: Patna (state capital)
 - ✓ Infrastructure: Large convention facilities (Gyan Bhawan)
 - ✓ Role: Administrative + logistics hub
- Key Facts
 - ✓ Agency: APEDA (agri-export promotion body)
 - ✓ Core aim: Boost exports from Bihar
 - ✓ Strategy: GI products + agri surplus promotion

Additional Information

- WWF:
 - ✓ Report: Living Planet Report
 - ✓ Focus: Vertebrate population decline
 - ✓ Role: Uses IUCN data
- UNEP:
 - ✓ Reports: Global Environment Outlook
 - ✓ Role: Policy + environmental assessment
 - ✓ Not species-level taxonomy authority
- FAO:
 - ✓ Report: SOFIA (State of World Fisheries and Aquaculture)
 - ✓ Focus: Fisheries + food security + economic resource use
 - ✓ Not biodiversity conservation assessment body

Q 109. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Garudakshi – Forest Crime Management System
 - ✓ Launch: January 2025
 - ✓ State: Karnataka
 - ✓ Department: Karnataka Forest Department
 - ✓ Collaboration: Wildlife Trust of India (WTI)
 - ✓ Type: Cloud-based Online Forest Offence Information Management System
- Objective
 - ✓ Purpose: Digitisation and management of forest + wildlife crime records
- Functions:

Q 108. Ans. B

Explanation:

- IUCN Global Freshwater Species Assessment

- ✓ FIR registration digitisation
- ✓ Crime tracking
- ✓ Enforcement monitoring
- Crimes Covered
 - ✓ Poaching
 - ✓ Illegal tree felling
 - ✓ Forest encroachment

Additional Information

- Kerala:
 - ✓ System: “Hawk” (Hostile Activity Watch Kernel)
 - ✓ Focus: Wildlife crime monitoring system
- Tamil Nadu:
 - ✓ Apps: Kaval Uthavi (safety), KaWaCHaM (disaster warning)
 - ✓ Focus: Public safety + disaster management
- Andhra Pradesh:
 - ✓ Apps: Suraksha, Disha (women safety systems)
 - ✓ Focus: Personal safety governance tools

Q 110. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Platform name: Global Matchmaking Platform (GMP)
 - ✓ Launch event: COP29
 - ✓ Host city: Baku
 - ✓ Host country: Azerbaijan
 - ✓ Launch time: November 2024
 - ✓ Primary objective: Support industrial decarbonization
 - ✓ Target sectors: Steel, Cement, Chemicals
 - ✓ Sector category: Hard-to-abate industries
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Secretariat host organisation: United Nations Industrial Development Organisation (UNIDO)
 - ✓ Role of UNIDO: Official host of GMP Secretariat
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Institutional linkage:
 - Parent initiative: Climate Club
 - Leading countries behind the Climate Club: Germany and Chile
 - Climate Club Secretariat hosts: OECD and IEA
 - ✓ Financial support at launch:

- Total initial funding mobilised: 420–500 million US dollars
- Major contributors: Germany, the United Kingdom, and Canada
- Additional contributor: Climate Investment Funds (CIF)
- ✓ Industrial emissions context:
 - Key sectors prioritised: Iron and Steel, Cement, Chemicals and aluminium.
 - Share in industrial CO₂ emissions: About 70%
- ✓ Climate finance context:
 - Estimated annual funding gap for industrial decarbonization: About 125 billion US dollars by 2050
 - Current share of mitigation finance to industry: About 1.4%
- ✓ India-related linkage:
 - Related initiative: Industrial Deep Decarbonisation Initiative (IDDI)
 - India's role: Co-leader
 - Partner country: United Kingdom
 - Core objective of IDDI: Promote low-carbon steel and cement through green procurement
- ✓ COP29 key facts:
 - Venue: Baku, Azerbaijan
 - Official theme: In Solidarity for a Green World
 - Major agenda item: New Collective Quantified Goal (NCQG) on climate finance
- ✓ UNIDO presence in India:
 - Regional office location: New Delhi
 - Collaborating ministries: Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Ministry of MSME
 - Focus area: Clean technology and energy efficiency projects

Q 111. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Guneri Inland Mangroves
 - ✓ Site name: Inland Mangrove of Guneri
 - ✓ Location: Kutch district, Gujarat
 - ✓ Status: Biodiversity Heritage Site (BHS)
 - ✓ Authority: Gujarat State Government
 - ✓ Species: *Avicennia marina* (Grey Mangrove)

- Unique Features
 - ✓ Type: Inland (land-locked) mangrove ecosystem
 - ✓ Distance from coast: ~100 km
 - ✓ Nature: "Fossil mangrove forest"
 - ✓ Origin: Remnant of ancient sea coverage in Rann of Kutch
 - ✓ Water source: Sub-surface saline water (paleo-salinity)
 - ✓ Classification: Relict vegetation
 - Ecological Significance
 - ✓ Adaptation: Survives in arid desert-like conditions
 - ✓ Hydrology: Non-tidal saline groundwater-dependent
 - ✓ Significance: Ancient coastal ecosystem preservation
- Additional Information**
- Odisha:
 - ✓ Major mangrove: Bhitarkanika Mangroves
 - ✓ Type: Coastal/estuarine system
 - Andhra Pradesh:
 - ✓ Major mangrove: Coringa Wildlife Sanctuary
 - ✓ Type: Estuarine mangroves along the coastline
 - ✓ Focus: Coastal restoration

Q 112. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Project name: Kosi–Mehi Intra-State Link Project
 - ✓ Approval authority: Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA)
 - ✓ Approval time: March 2025
 - ✓ Scheme under which included: PMKSY–AIBP
 - ✓ Full scheme name: Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchai Yojana – Accelerated Irrigation Benefits Programme (AIBP)
- Statement 2 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Canal used for linking: Eastern Kosi Main Canal (EKMC)
 - ✓ Incorrect canal mentioned: Western Kosi Main Canal
 - ✓ Remodelling length: Up to 41.30 km
 - ✓ Extension length: Up to 117.50 km
- ✓ Purpose: Connect EKMC to Mechi River
- Statement 3 is correct:
 - ✓ Total estimated project cost: ₹6,282.32 crore
 - ✓ Central Government assistance: ₹3,652.56 crore
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Project timeline and completion:
 - ✓ Scheduled completion deadline: March 2029
 - ✓ Beneficiary districts in Bihar:
 - Araria
 - Purnea
 - Kishanganj
 - Katihar
 - Region covered: Seemanchal
 - ✓ Irrigation coverage:
 - Total area to receive irrigation: About 2,10,516 hectares
 - ✓ Water diversion objective:
 - Source basin: Kosi basin
 - Target basin: Mahananda basin
 - Estimated surplus water diversion: About 2,050 million cubic meters
 - ✓ River geography facts:
 - Mechi River origin: Mahabharat Range, Nepal
 - Mechi River type: Transboundary river
 - Mechi River joins: Mahananda River (right-bank tributary)
 - ✓ Kosi River facts:
 - Nickname: Sorrow of Bihar
 - Entry point into India: Near Bhimnagar, Supaul
 - Confluence with Ganga: Near Kursela, Katihar district
 - ✓ Scheme-specific fact:
 - PMKSY phase relevant: PMKSY 2.0 (2021–26)
 - Position in scheme list: 10th project inducted under the AIBP component

Q 113. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Sansad Bhashini Initiative
 - ✓ Type: AI-based real-time language translation system
 - ✓ Platform: Indian Parliament
 - ✓ Based on: Bhashini (National Language Translation Mission)

- ✓ **Objective**
 - Purpose: Remove language barriers in Parliament
 - Function: Real-time translation of debates, speeches, and documents
 - Languages covered: 22 Scheduled Indian languages
- ✓ **Key Features**
 - Translation type: Audio + text interpretation
 - Technology:
 - ◇ ASR (Automatic Speech Recognition)
 - ◇ NMT (Neural Machine Translation)
 - ◇ TTS (Text-to-Speech)
 - User benefit:
 - ◇ MPs speak in their mother tongue
 - ◇ Instant understanding by other MPs
- ✓ Total smaller alignment stones: Around 1,200
- ✓ Estimated age: About 3,000 years
- ✓ Key significance: Megalithic astronomical alignment site
- ✓ Astronomical link: Alignment with solar solstices and constellations such as Ursa Major

- **Varkala Cliffs (Kerala):**
 - ✓ State: Kerala
 - ✓ District: Thiruvananthapuram
 - ✓ UNESCO status: Added in September 2025
 - ✓ Cliff length: About 7.5 km
 - ✓ Geological formation exposed: Warkalli Formation
 - ✓ Geological age: Mio-Pliocene
 - ✓ Unique feature: Only Cenozoic sedimentary cliffs along India's western coast
 - ✓ Rare mineral present: Jarosite (also found on Mars)
- **Gandikota Grand Canyon: Not on UNESCO Tentative List**
 - ✓ Location: Kadapa district
 - ✓ State: Andhra Pradesh
 - ✓ Formation cause: Penna River cutting through Erramala Hills
 - ✓ Current status: Centrally protected monument under ASI
 - ✓ Future plan: Proposal preparation for tentative listing in upcoming cycles
- **Additional Facts:**
 - ✓ India UNESCO Tentative List status (after 2025 additions):
 - Total properties: 69
 - Cultural sites: 49
 - Natural sites: 17
 - Mixed sites: 3
 - ✓ Important UNESCO listing process concept:
 - Tentative List meaning: Preliminary list of sites nominated before final World Heritage nomination
 - Mandatory condition: A site must first be placed on the Tentative List before final UNESCO nomination

Additional Information

- **Bhashini Ecosystem:**
 - ✓ Part of Digital India initiative
 - ✓ Goal: Language accessibility in digital services
- **Digital Sansad Project:**
 - ✓ Aim: Paperless + accessible Parliament
 - ✓ Tools: Unified portal + mobile app

Q 114. Ans. B

Explanation:

- **Kanger Valley National Park (Chhattisgarh):**
 - ✓ State: Chhattisgarh
 - ✓ District: Bastar
 - ✓ UNESCO status: Added to Tentative List in 2025
 - ✓ Key feature: Limestone karst landscape
 - ✓ Famous cave: Kotumsar Cave
 - ✓ Depth of cave: About 35 meters below ground
 - ✓ Major waterfall: Tirathgarh Waterfalls
 - ✓ River/stream associated: Mugabahr stream
- **Mudumal Menhirs (Telangana):**
 - ✓ State: Telangana
 - ✓ District: Narayanpet
 - ✓ UNESCO status: Added to Tentative List in 2025
 - ✓ Total large standing stones (menhirs): About 80

Q 115. Ans. A

Explanation:

- **Statement 1 is correct:**
 - ✓ Top remittance source country: United States

- ✓ Share in total remittances to India: 27.7%
- ✓ Reference period: 2023–24
- ✓ Status: Largest contributor to India's inward remittances
- Statement 2 is incorrect:
 - ✓ States grouped with Bihar: Uttar Pradesh and Rajasthan
 - ✓ Combined share of these three states: Less than 6%
 - ✓ Implication: Bihar's individual share is significantly below 3%
 - ✓ Incorrect claim: Bihar has a high share
- Statement 3 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Top remittance-receiving state: Maharashtra
 - ✓ Share of Maharashtra: 20.5%
 - ✓ Second-ranked state: Kerala
 - ✓ Share of Kerala: 19.7%
 - ✓ Incorrect claim: Kerala remains the top recipient
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Total remittance inflow to India:
 - Total amount received: 118.7 billion US dollars
 - India's global status: Largest remittance-receiving country
 - ✓ Top source countries of remittances:
 - First: United States — 27.7%
 - Second: United Arab Emirates — 19.2%
 - Third: United Kingdom — 10.8%
 - ✓ Advanced Economies vs Gulf region share:
 - Advanced Economies share: 51.2%
 - Major countries included: USA, UK, Canada, Australia, Singapore
 - Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) share: 37.9%
 - ✓ Top remittance-receiving states in India:
 - First: Maharashtra — 20.5%
 - Second: Kerala — 19.7%
 - Third: Tamil Nadu — 10.4%
 - Fourth: Telangana — 8.1%
 - Fifth: Karnataka — 7.7%
 - ✓ Digital transfer trend:
 - Share of remittances via digital channels: 73.5%
 - ✓ Cost of sending remittances:
 - Average cost of sending 200 US dollars to India: 4.9%
 - UN Sustainable Development Goal target cost: 3%

Q 116. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Mission name: National Technical Textiles Mission (NTTM)
 - ✓ Approval authority: Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA)
 - ✓ Launch year: 2020
 - ✓ Nodal ministry: Ministry of Textiles
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Total budget outlay: ₹1,480 crore
 - ✓ Original duration: FY 2020–21 to FY 2023–24
 - ✓ Extended duration: Up to March 31, 2026
 - ✓ Effective coverage period: Up to FY 2025–26
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Budget allocation pattern:
 - Largest allocation component: Research, Innovation and Development
 - Amount allocated: ₹1,000 crore
 - ✓ Technical textile classification (12 categories):
 - Agrotech
 - Buildtech
 - Clothtech
 - Geotech
 - Hometech
 - Indutech
 - Meditech
 - Mobiltech
 - Oekotech
 - Packtech
 - Protech
 - Sportstech
 - ✓ Startup support under NTTM:
 - Scheme name: GREAT (Grant for Research and Entrepreneurship across Aspiring Innovators in Technical Textiles)
 - Maximum grant amount: ₹50 lakh
 - Purpose: Commercialization of technical textile innovations
 - ✓ Related Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme:
 - Target sectors: Man-Made Fibre (MMF) apparel, MMF fabrics, Technical Textiles
 - Approved outlay: ₹10,683 crore

- ✓ PM MITRA Parks (Geographical locations):
 - Total parks approved: 7
 - Locations:
 - ◇ Virudhunagar — Tamil Nadu
 - ◇ Warangal — Telangana
 - ◇ Navsari — Gujarat
 - ◇ Kalaburagi — Karnataka
 - ◇ Dhar — Madhya Pradesh
 - ◇ Lucknow — Uttar Pradesh
 - ◇ Amravati — Maharashtra
- ✓ Olympic medals: 7-time medalist
- ✓ IOC role: Former Chair, Athletes' Commission
- Key Initiative
 - ✓ Programme: "Fit for the Future"
 - ✓ Purpose: Review + shape Olympic movement for 2030s
- Strategic Context
 - ✓ Upcoming event: Dakar 2026 Youth Olympic Games
 - ✓ Significance: First Olympic event on African soil
 - ✓ Role: Promoted by Coventry

Q 117. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Report name: Becoming a High-Income Economy in a Generation
 - ✓ Released by: World Bank
- Key Findings
 - ✓ Required growth rate: 7.8% average annually
 - ✓ Time period: Next 22 years
 - ✓ Target year: 2047
 - ✓ Objective: Achieve high-income country status
- Income Transition Path
 - ✓ 2007–08 status: Low Middle-Income Country (LMIC)
 - ✓ Projected status by 2032: Upper Middle-Income Country (UMIC)
- Key Facts
 - ✓ **Core challenge:** Transition from middle-income to high-income
 - ✓ **Strategy base:** Sustained high growth over long term
 - ✓ **Policy linkage:** Viksit Bharat @ 2047 vision

Q 118. Ans. B

Explanation:

- President: Kirsty Coventry
 - ✓ Country: Zimbabwe
 - ✓ Position: 10th President of IOC
 - ✓ Election: 144th IOC Session
 - ✓ Date: 20 March 2025
 - ✓ Location: Costa Navarino, Greece
- Historic Significance
 - ✓ First female IOC President
 - ✓ First African IOC President
- Background
 - ✓ Sport: Swimming

Q 119. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Missile name: Gandiva
 - ✓ Previous designation: Astra Mk-3
 - ✓ Missile type: Beyond-Visual-Range Air-to-Air Missile (BVRAAM)
 - ✓ Category: Next-generation indigenous air-to-air missile
- ✓ Statement 2 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Development agency: Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
 - ✓ Production agency: Bharat Dynamics Limited (BDL)
 - ✓ India–Russia joint missile project: BrahMos supersonic cruise missile
- Statement 3 is correct:
 - ✓ Propulsion technology used: Solid Fuel-Ducted Ramjet (SFDR)
 - ✓ Key feature: Uses atmospheric oxygen as oxidizer
 - ✓ Operational advantage: Sustains supersonic speeds for long duration
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Missile naming origin:
 - Name inspiration: Gandiva (bow of Arjuna)
 - Source: Mahabharata
 - ✓ Range and speed capabilities:
 - Estimated range: About 300–350 km
 - Approximate operational range figure: Around 340 km at high altitude
 - Speed range: Mach 2.0 to Mach 3.6
 - ✓ Aircraft compatibility:
 - Primary deployment aircraft: Sukhoi Su-30MKI

- Indigenous aircraft integration: Light Combat Aircraft (LCA) Tejas
- ✓ Astra missile series progression:
 - Astra Mk-1 range: About 80–110 km
 - Astra Mk-2 range: About 140–160 km
 - Key feature in Mk-2: Dual-pulse solid rocket motor
- ✓ Technology advantage of SFDR:
 - Key capability: Throttle-able thrust control
 - Operational benefit: Expands No-Escape Zone
 - Combat impact: Reduces chances of enemy aircraft evasion

Q 120. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Abel Prize 2025
 - ✓ Awarded by: Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters
 - ✓ Recipient: Masaki Kashiwara
 - ✓ Country: Japan
- Citation
 - ✓ Contribution: Algebraic analysis + representation theory
 - ✓ Recognition: Foundational contributions
- Key Contributions
 - ✓ Algebraic Analysis:
 - Use of algebraic methods for solving linear partial differential equations
 - ✓ Riemann–Hilbert Correspondence:
 - Link between the topology of complex varieties and differential equations
 - ✓ Representation Theory:
 - Concept: Crystal bases
 - Impact: Understanding group actions on vector spaces
- Significance
 - ✓ Nickname: “Nobel Prize of Mathematics”
 - ✓ Impact area: Pure mathematics + theoretical physics
 - ✓ Applications:
 - Quantum Field Theory
 - String Theory

Additional Information

- Terence Tao:
 - ✓ Fields Medalist
 - ✓ Known for: Harmonic analysis + number theory

- ✓ Not Abel Prize winner (as of 2026)
- Andrew Wiles:
 - ✓ Known for: Fermat’s Last Theorem
 - ✓ Abel Prize: 2016
- Peter Scholze:
 - ✓ Fields Medalist (2018)
 - ✓ Field: Arithmetic geometry

Q 121. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Meeting: 7th National Board for Wildlife (NBWL) meeting
 - ✓ Chairperson: Prime Minister Narendra Modi
 - ✓ Meeting date: March 3, 2025
 - ✓ Occasion: World Wildlife Day
 - ✓ Venue: Gir National Park
 - ✓ State: Gujarat
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Report released: India’s first riverine dolphin population estimation report
 - ✓ Total dolphins recorded: 6,327
 - ✓ Total rivers covered: 28
 - ✓ State with highest population: Uttar Pradesh
 - ✓ Dolphins in Uttar Pradesh: 2,397
 - ✓ Second highest state: Bihar
 - ✓ Dolphins in Bihar: 2,220
 - ✓ Other major states:
 - ✓ West Bengal: 815
 - ✓ Assam: 635
- Statement 3 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Asiatic Lion Population Estimation frequency: Once every five years
 - ✓ Previous estimation cycle: 2020
 - ✓ Lions recorded in 2020: 674
 - ✓ Current cycle initiated: 16th cycle
 - ✓ Cycle year: 2025
- Statement 4 is correct:
 - ✓ Project expanded: Project Cheetah
 - ✓ New site added: Gandhisagar Sanctuary
 - ✓ State: Madhya Pradesh
 - ✓ Second new site added: Banni Grasslands
 - ✓ State: Gujarat
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ New conservation initiatives announced:
 - Species-specific task forces created for:
 - Indian Sloth Bear

- Gharial
- Great Indian Bustard
- ✓ New institutions announced:
 - Centre of Excellence for Human-Wildlife Conflict
 - Location: SACON campus
 - City: Coimbatore
 - State: Tamil Nadu
- ✓ Wildlife health infrastructure:
 - Institution: National Referral Centre for Wildlife
 - Location: Junagadh
 - State: Gujarat
- ✓ NBWL institutional structure:
 - Type of body: Statutory apex wildlife body
 - Legal basis: Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972
 - Total members: 47
 - Chairperson: Prime Minister of India
 - Vice-Chairperson: Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change

Q 122. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Madhav National Park – Tiger Reserve
 - ✓ State: Madhya Pradesh
 - ✓ Notification: March 2025
 - ✓ Authority: National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA)
 - ✓ Status: 58th Tiger Reserve of India
- Key Objective
 - ✓ Purpose: Re-establish tiger population
 - ✓ Region: Gwalior–Shivpuri landscape
 - ✓ Role: Restore historical wildlife corridor
- Restoration Background
 - ✓ Past status: Tigers locally extinct
 - ✓ Reintroduction start: 2023
 - ✓ Source reserves:
 - ✓ Satpura Tiger Reserve
 - ✓ Bandhavgarh Tiger Reserve
- Strategic Importance
 - ✓ Corridor linkage:
 - Panna Tiger Reserve (MP)
 - Ranthambore Tiger Reserve (Rajasthan)
 - Function: Genetic exchange between tiger populations

Q 123. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Okjökull Glacier
 - ✓ Location: Iceland
 - ✓ Meaning: “Ok Glacier”
 - ✓ First glacier officially declared dead
 - ✓ Status change
 - Declared: No longer a glacier
 - Reason: Insufficient mass to flow
 - ✓ Scientific Criterion:
 - Glacier must move under its own weight
 - Declared by: Oddur Sigurðsson

Q 124. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Constitutional basis: Article 243-I
 - ✓ Applies to: Panchayats
 - ✓ Additional constitutional basis: Article 243-Y
 - ✓ Applies to: Municipalities
 - ✓ Purpose: Constitution of the State Finance Commission (SFC) to review the financial position of local bodies.
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Commission name: Seventh State Finance Commission (Bihar)
 - ✓ Chairperson appointed: Ashok Kumar Choudhary
 - ✓ Service background: Retired IAS officer
 - ✓ Batch year: 1972
- Statement 3 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Recommendation period: 2026–27 to 2030–31
 - ✓ Incorrect year mentioned: 2025–26
 - ✓ Deadline for submission of report: March 31, 2026
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Statutory provisions in Bihar’s laws:
 - Relevant Act: Bihar Panchayati Raj Act, 2006
 - Relevant section: Section 168
 - Urban governance law: Bihar Municipal Act, 2007
 - Relevant section: Section 71
 - ✓ Composition of the Commission:
 - Total members: 3

- Chairperson: Ashok Kumar Choudhary
- Member: Anil Kumar (Retired Bihar Administrative Service officer)
- Member: Dr. Kumudani Sinha
- Professional background of Dr. Kumudani Sinha: Former Professor of Economics, Patna University
- ✓ Digital initiative:
 - Official portal launched: February 2026
 - Portal purpose: Collect suggestions from citizens and stakeholders
 - Focus area: Financial condition of Panchayati Raj Institutions and Urban Local Bodies
- ✓ Historical background:
 - Origin of State Finance Commissions: 73rd and 74th Constitutional Amendment Acts
 - Year of amendments: 1992
 - First State Finance Commission in Bihar: Constituted in 1995
 - Operational period of first SFC: 1996–2001
- ✓ Core mandate of SFC:
 - Key function: Recommend distribution of state tax revenue
 - Beneficiaries: Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs) and Urban Local Bodies (ULBs)
 - Additional role: Recommend grants-in-aid from the State Consolidated Fund

Q 125. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Patharkatti
 - ✓ State: Bihar
 - ✓ Type: Stone craft
 - ✓ Material: Dark local stone
 - ✓ Features:
 - Intricate carving
 - Household items
 - Link: Vishnupad Temple construction
- ✓ Chanabara
 - State: West Bengal
 - Origin: Murshidabad
 - Base: Chhena (cottage cheese)
- ✓ Features:
 - Fried exterior (dark, firm)
 - Soft interior

- Ryndia Silk
 - ✓ State: Meghalaya
 - ✓ Also called: Peace Silk / Eri Silk
 - ✓ **Feature:**
 - No killing of silkworm
 - ✓ Properties:
 - Warm
 - Durable
 - Organic
 - Communities: Khasi, Jaintia
- Tungbuk
 - ✓ State: Sikkim
 - ✓ Community: Lepcha
 - ✓ Type: Plucked string instrument
 - ✓ **Material:**
 - Single wood piece
 - Animal skin covering
 - Use: Folk music + rituals

Q 126. Ans. C

Explanation:

- UpLink Platform (WEF)
 - ✓ Launch: January 2020
 - ✓ Event: WEF Annual Meeting, Davos
 - ✓ Developed by: World Economic Forum (WEF)
 - ✓ Type: Digital crowdsourcing platform
- Objective
 - ✓ Purpose: Accelerate UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)
 - ✓ Function: Connect innovators with global stakeholders
- Key Stakeholders
 - ✓ Innovators: Early-stage entrepreneurs
- Network access:
 - ✓ CEOs
 - ✓ Investors
 - ✓ Governments
- Working Mechanism
 - ✓ Model: Innovation Challenges (competition-based)
 - ✓ Focus: Solving global crises
- Unique Feature
 - ✓ Not just funding: Provides global visibility
 - ✓ Outcome: Direct access to decision-makers
 - ✓ Impact: Enables scaling via policy support + large contracts

Q 127. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Rushikonda Beach
 - ✓ Location: Visakhapatnam (City of Destiny), Andhra Pradesh
 - ✓ Status: Only Blue Flag beach in Andhra Pradesh
 - ✓ Certification: Blue Flag eco-label
- 2025 Status Update
 - ✓ Suspension: February 2025
- Reason:
 - ✓ Sanitation lapses
 - ✓ Security issues
 - ✓ Stray animal management
 - ✓ Reinstatement: March 2025
 - ✓ Action taken: Clean-up drive + infrastructure upgrades
- Blue Flag Certification – Key Facts
 - ✓ Type: International eco-label
 - ✓ Scope: Beaches, marinas, sustainable boating tourism
 - ✓ Issuing body: Foundation for Environmental Education (FEE), Denmark
- Criteria Framework
 - ✓ Total criteria: 33
- Categories:
 - ✓ Environmental Education and Information
 - ✓ Water Quality: Must be “Excellent”
 - ✓ Environmental Management: Litter control + waste recycling
 - ✓ Safety and Services: Lifeguards, first aid, accessibility
- Key Facts
 - ✓ Nature: Voluntary certification
 - ✓ Focus: Environmental sustainability + tourist safety
 - ✓ Significance: Global standard for clean and safe beaches

Q 128. Ans. C

Explanation:

- WPI Base Year Revision Committee (2025)
 - ✓ Constituted by: Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT)
 - ✓ Purpose: Revision of WPI base year
 - ✓ Old base year: 2011–12
 - ✓ Proposed base year: 2022–23
- Chairperson

- ✓ Chair: Ramesh Chand
- ✓ Position: Full-time Member, NITI Aayog
- Key Objectives
 - ✓ Commodity basket revision:
 - ✓ Update list of goods reflecting current economy
 - ✓ Examples: Medicinal plants, gym equipment, new tech products

Additional Information

- Soumya Kanti Ghosh: Member (SBI Group Chief Economic Advisor)
- Surjit Bhalla: Non-official Member (Former IMF Executive Director for India)
- Shamika Ravi: Non-official Member (EAC-PM Member)

Q 129. Ans. C

Explanation:

- FBI Director – Kash Patel
 - ✓ Position: Director, Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI)
 - ✓ Confirmed: U.S. Senate
 - ✓ Took office: Early 2025
 - ✓ Predecessor: Christopher Wray
- Historic Significance
 - ✓ First FBI Director of Indian origin
- Professional Background
 - ✓ Early career:
 - Public defender
 - DOJ prosecutor (national security + terrorism cases)
- Congressional role:
 - ✓ Lead investigator: House Intelligence Committee
 - ✓ Associated with: “Nunes Memo”
- Executive role:
 - ✓ Chief of Staff to Acting U.S. Secretary of Defense
 - ✓ Period: Trump administration
- Key Facts
 - ✓ Institution: FBI (premier U.S. federal law enforcement agency)
 - ✓ Career domain: National security + intelligence + defense
 - ✓ Significance: High-level Indian-origin leadership in U.S. governance

Q 130. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Kampala Declaration on the Transformation of Africa's Agri-Food Systems
 - ✓ Adopted by: African Union (AU)
 - ✓ Adoption: Early 2025
 - ✓ Summit: 38th AU Summit
 - ✓ Validity: 2025–2035 (10-year roadmap)
 - ✓ Replaces: Malabo Declaration (2014)
- Strategic Shift
 - ✓ Old focus: Agricultural productivity
 - ✓ New focus: Agri-food systems approach
- Key Objectives
 - ✓ Goal: Food sovereignty + food security
- Challenge addressed:
 - ✓ Climate change impacts
 - ✓ Global supply chain disruptions
- Key Pillars
 - ✓ Resilience and Climate Adaptation:
 - ✓ Focus: Climate-Smart Agriculture (CSA)
 - ✓ Regions: Sahel, East Africa (droughts, floods)
- Key Facts
 - ✓ Framework type: Continental agricultural strategy
 - ✓ Importance: Integrated food system transformation
 - ✓ Trend: Sustainability + technology-driven agriculture

Q 131. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Project name: Abathasahayeswarar Temple Conservation Project
 - ✓ Location: Thukkatchi village
 - ✓ District: Thiruvavur (Tamil Nadu)
 - ✓ Award received: Award of Distinction
 - ✓ Event: UNESCO Asia-Pacific Awards for Cultural Heritage Conservation 2024
 - ✓ Temple age: Approximately 1,300 years
 - ✓ Original builders: Chola dynasty rulers (including Vikrama Chola and Kulothunga Chola)
 - ✓ Key conservation feature: Use of traditional temple architecture knowledge (Sthapathis) along with modern structural techniques
- Statement 2 is incorrect:

- ✓ Project name: Sir Byramjee Jeejeebhoy Parsee Charitable Institution (BJPCI) Conservation Project
- ✓ Location: Mumbai
- ✓ Actual award received: Award of Merit

Additional facts:

- ✓ Highest award in 2024 cycle:
 - Project receiving Award of Excellence: Inari-yu Bathhouse Restoration Project
 - Location: Tokyo, Japan
 - Significance: Top-tier recognition among all Asia-Pacific heritage conservation projects
- ✓ Indian performance in 2024 awards:
 - Total Indian award-winning projects: 2
 - Winning projects:
 - Abathasahayeswarar Temple (Tamil Nadu)
 - BJPCI Building (Mumbai)
- ✓ BJPCI heritage details:
 - Year of construction: 1908
 - Architectural style: Gothic
 - Type of structure: Heritage school building
- ✓ UNESCO award structure (Five Categories):
 - Award of Excellence (highest)
 - Award of Distinction
 - Award of Merit
 - Award for New Design in Heritage Contexts
 - Special Recognition for Sustainable Development
- ✓ Administrative detail:
 - Administering office: UNESCO Regional Office
 - Location: Bangkok, Thailand

Q 132. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Banjara Virasat 'Nagara' Museum
 - ✓ Museum: Banjara Virasat 'Nagara' Museum
 - ✓ Location: Pohradevi, Washim district, Maharashtra
 - ✓ Inaugurated by: PM Narendra Modi
 - ✓ Dedicated to: Banjara community heritage
- Pohradevi Significance
 - ✓ Title: "Kashi" of Banjara community
- Key sites:
 - ✓ Samadhi of Sant Sevalal Maharaj

- ✓ Jagadamba Mata shrine
- ✓ Importance: Major spiritual center for Banjaras
- Museum Features
 - ✓ Purpose: Preserve nomadic cultural identity
 - ✓ Design: Inspired by “Nagara” (traditional drum)
 - ✓ Structure: Four-story building
- Technology Use
 - ✓ Tools: 3D maps + interactive displays
 - ✓ Function: Trace migration across India
- Banjara Community – Key Facts
 - ✓ Other names: Lambani, Gormati
 - ✓ Social classification: SC / ST / OBC (varies by state)
 - ✓ Traditional lifestyle: Nomadic traders
- Key Facts
 - ✓ Symbol: Nagara drum (cultural identity)
 - ✓ Significance: Cultural recognition + heritage preservation
 - ✓ Trend: Integration into mainstream socio-economic structure
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Scheme financial outlay:
 - Initial approved outlay: ₹22,919 crore
 - Revised outlay (Budget 2026–27): ₹40,000 crore
 - ✓ Scheme structure (segment-based incentives):
 - Segment A and B: Sub-assemblies and bare components
 - ◇ Incentive type: Turnover Linked Incentive
 - ◇ Tenure: 6 years
 - Segment C: High-tech components such as HDI PCBs
 - ◇ Incentive type: Hybrid incentive model
 - Segment D: Capital equipment and supply-chain ecosystem
 - ◇ Incentive type: Capital expenditure incentive
 - ◇ Tenure: 5 years
 - Segment E: Sub-assembly — Telecom
 - ✓ Target manufacturing components:
 - Display modules
 - Camera modules
 - Multi-layer printed circuit boards (PCBs)
 - Lithium-ion cells for digital devices
 - ✓ Strategic policy linkage:
 - Predecessor scheme: SPECS (Scheme for Promotion of Manufacturing of Electronic Components and Semiconductors)
 - Complementary programme: Production Linked Incentive (PLI) 2.0 for IT Hardware
 - ✓ Domestic manufacturing goal:
 - Current Domestic Value Addition (DVA): About 18–20%
 - Target DVA by 2030: About 35–40%
 - ✓ Semiconductor ecosystem linkage:
 - Associated mission: India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) 2.0
 - Role of ECMS: Support upstream materials and equipment for the semiconductor ecosystem

Q 133. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Scheme name: Electronics Component Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS)
 - ✓ Launching ministry: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)
 - ✓ Launch time: April 2025
 - ✓ Primary objective: Strengthen domestic electronics component manufacturing
 - ✓ Strategic goal: Deepen India’s electronics value chain
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Incentive model used: Turnover Linked Incentive (TLI)
 - ✓ Total scheme tenure: 6 years
 - ✓ Gestation period: 1 year
 - ✓ Purpose of gestation period: Setting up and commissioning manufacturing facilities
- Statement 3 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Eligible project types: Both Greenfield and Brownfield projects
 - ✓ Greenfield meaning: New manufacturing units
 - ✓ Brownfield meaning: Expansion of existing units
- Statement 1 is correct:

Q 134. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:

- ✓ 24th Summit of Council of Heads of State of SCO
 - ✓ Host city: Astana
 - ✓ Host country: Kazakhstan
 - ✓ Summit dates: July 3 to 4, 2024
 - Statement 2 is incorrect:
 - ✓ India and Pakistan accession process start: Ufa Summit 2015
 - ✓ Full membership granted: June 2017
 - ✓ Summit granting membership: Astana Summit
 - Statement 3 is correct:
 - ✓ Event: SCO Summit 2022
 - ✓ Host city: Samarkand
 - ✓ Tourism and Cultural Capital declared: Kashi (Varanasi)
 - ✓ Designation period: 2022–2023
 - ✓ Special status: First-ever SCO Tourism and Cultural Capital
 - Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Recent SCO expansion:
 - Newest member admitted: Belarus
 - Admission year: 2024
 - Member number after inclusion: 10th
 - Previous member added: Iran
 - Iran admission year: 2023
 - ✓ Current SCO member states:
 - China
 - Russia
 - Kazakhstan
 - Kyrgyzstan
 - Tajikistan
 - Uzbekistan
 - India
 - Pakistan
 - Iran
 - Belarus
 - ✓ Observer states:
 - Afghanistan
 - Mongolia
 - ✓ Tourism and Cultural Capital updates:
 - City designated for 2024–2025: Qingdao
 - Country: China
 - Previous Tourism and Cultural Capital: Almaty
 - Country: Kazakhstan
 - ✓ Institutional headquarters:
 - SCO Secretariat location: Beijing, China
 - RATS headquarters: Tashkent, Uzbekistan
 - ✓ Historical origin:
 - Original grouping name: Shanghai Five
 - Formation year: 1996
 - Original members: China, Russia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Tajikistan
 - Renamed organisation: Shanghai Cooperation Organisation
 - Renaming year: 2001
 - Country added during renaming: Uzbekistan
- Q 135. Ans. C**
- Explanation:**
- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Alliance name: International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA)
 - ✓ Headquarters location: New Delhi
 - ✓ Agreement signed: Headquarters Agreement (HQA)
 - ✓ Signing ministry: Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)
 - ✓ Signing time: October 2024
 - Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Approval authority: Union Cabinet
 - ✓ Initial financial support: ₹150 crore
 - ✓ Funding type: One-time central budgetary grant
 - ✓ Funding duration: 5 years
 - ✓ Funding period: 2023–24 to 2027–28
 - Statement 3 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Declaration name: St Petersburg Declaration on Tiger Conservation
 - ✓ Declaration year: 2010
 - ✓ Correct target: Double the global tiger population (TX2 goal)
 - ✓ Target year: 2022
 - Additional Facts:
 - ✓ IBCA launch details:
 - Launch date: April 9, 2023
 - Launched by: Prime Minister Narendra Modi
 - Launch location: Mysuru, Karnataka
 - Commemoration event: 50 years of Project Tiger
 - Project Tiger launch year: 1973
 - ✓ Big cats under IBCA focus:
 - Total species covered: 7
 - ◇ Tiger
 - ◇ Lion

- ◇ Leopard
- ◇ Snow Leopard
- ◇ Puma
- ◇ Jaguar
- ◇ Cheetah
- ✓ Big cats found in India:
 - Tiger
 - Lion
 - Leopard
 - Snow Leopard
 - Cheetah
- ✓ Species not found in India: Puma and Jaguar
- ✓ India Big Cat Population Data:
 - Tiger population in India: 3,682 (2022 census)
 - India share of global tiger population: About 75%
 - State with highest tigers: Madhya Pradesh (785)
 - Second highest tiger state: Karnataka (563)
- ✓ Leopard population in India: 13,874 (2022 census)
- ✓ State with the highest leopards: Madhya Pradesh (3,907)
- ✓ Snow Leopard population estimate: 718
- ✓ Assessment name: Snow Leopard Population Assessment of India (SPAI)
- ✓ Assessment year: 2024
- ✓ Region with the highest snow leopards: Ladakh (477)
- ✓ Alternate name (China side): Changbaishan
- Fjord Coast Geopark:
 - ✓ Country: Norway
 - ✓ Geological focus: Study of the Caledonian mountain range
 - ✓ Mountain history: Once comparable in height to the Himalayas
- Lang Son Geopark:
 - ✓ Country: Vietnam
 - ✓ Major landform: Karst topography
 - ✓ Fossil record age: About 40 million years
- UNESCO Global Geoparks (UGGp):
 - ✓ Programme name: International Geoscience and Geoparks Programme (IGGP)
 - ✓ Concept initiation year: 2001
 - ✓ Official establishment: November 2015
 - ✓ Establishing body: UNESCO
 - ✓ Definition: Unified geographical areas with internationally significant geological heritage
 - ✓ Core pillars: Protection, education and sustainable development
 - ✓ Governance Model:
 - Approach type: Bottom-up model
 - Key feature: Direct involvement of local communities and indigenous groups
 - Economic tool promoted: Geotourism
 - ✓ Validation Cycle:
 - Recognition validity: 4 years
 - Revalidation frequency: Every 4 years
 - Green Card: Status renewed for 4 years
 - Yellow Card: 2 years granted to correct deficiencies
 - Red Card: UNESCO Global Geopark status withdrawn
- ✓ UNESCO Triple Crown:
 - World Heritage Sites (WHS):
 - ◇ Convention year: 1972
 - ◇ Focus: Cultural and natural sites
 - ◇ Key principle: Outstanding Universal Value (OUV)
 - Biosphere Reserves (MAB Programme):
 - ◇ Focus: Biodiversity conservation
 - ◇ Management model: Zonation system
 - ◇ Zones: Core, Buffer, Transition
 - Global Geoparks (UGGp):
 - ◇ Focus: Geological heritage
 - ◇ Key elements: Rocks, fossils, minerals and tectonic structures

Q 136. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Kanbula Geopark:
 - ✓ Country: China
 - ✓ Province: Qinghai
 - ✓ Geographical location: Northeastern edge of Qinghai-Tibet Plateau
 - ✓ Geological significance: Records the evolution of the ancient Tethys Ocean
- Mt Paektu Geopark:
 - ✓ Country: North Korea
 - ✓ National significance: First UNESCO Global Geopark of North Korea
 - ✓ Volcano type: Active stratovolcano
 - ✓ Major feature: Lake Chon caldera lake at the summit

- ◊ Development approach: Sustainable local economic development
- ✓ Global Statistics:
 - Total UNESCO Global Geoparks: Over 213
 - Total participating countries: 48
 - GGN headquarters: Paris
 - Country with the highest geoparks: China (40)
- ✓ India's Status:
 - Current UNESCO Global Geoparks in India: Zero
 - Common trap: India has WHS and Biosphere Reserves, but no Geoparks
 - World Heritage Sites in India: 43
 - UNESCO Biosphere Reserves in India: 12
- ✓ Nodal agency in India: Geological Survey of India (GSI)
- ✓ Declared Geological Heritage Sites in India: 34 National Geological Heritage Monument Sites
- ✓ Proposed UNESCO Global Geopark Sites in India
 - Mawmluh Cave:
 - ◊ State: Meghalaya
 - ◊ Scientific importance: Defines start of Meghalayan Age
 - ◊ Recognition body: International Union of Geological Sciences (IUGS)
 - ◊ Special status: Listed among the first 100 IUGS Geological Heritage Sites
 - St Mary's Island:
 - ◊ State: Karnataka
 - ◊ Key feature: Hexagonal columnar basalt formations
 - ◊ Geological origin: Separation of India from Madagascar
 - Lonar Lake:
 - ◊ State: Maharashtra
 - ◊ Special feature: Meteorite impact crater
 - ◊ Unique status: The only known impact crater formed in basalt rock
 - Bhedaghat–Lameta Ghat:
 - ◊ State: Madhya Pradesh
 - ◊ River location: Narmada River
 - ◊ Key feature: Marble rock formations
 - ◊ Scientific significance: Dinosaur fossils and eggs discovered

- Visakhapatnam Coast:
 - ◊ State: Andhra Pradesh
 - ◊ Key feature: Erra Matti Dibbalu red sand dunes
 - ◊ Associated cave system: Borra Caves

Q 137. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ AI Kiran: National initiative
 - ✓ Co-led by: Office of Principal Scientific Adviser (PSA) to the Government of India
 - ✓ Private partners: Verix, INK Women
- Statement 2 is incorrect:
 - ✓ AI Kiran: Independent platform aikiran.org
 - ✓ Not hosted on: DIKSHA platform
 - ✓ DIKSHA: Developed by the Ministry of Education and NCERT
 - ✓ DIKSHA purpose: School education resources repository and teacher training
- Statement 3 is true:
 - ✓ Core objective: Bridge the gender gap in the AI sector
 - ✓ Support provided: Mentorship, access to capital, global collaboration, blockchain-verified recognition
- Key supporting facts:
 - ✓ Launch date: April 21, 2025
 - ✓ Launch occasion: UN World Creativity and Innovation Day
- Gender gap statistics:
 - ✓ Women in junior-level GenAI roles in India: About 33%
 - ✓ Women in senior leadership GenAI roles in India: About 19%
- Key focus sectors:
 - ✓ Healthcare
 - ✓ Education
 - ✓ Sustainability

Q 138. Ans. B

Explanation:

- BatEchoMon (Bat Echolocation Monitoring)
 - ✓ Developed by: Indian Institute for Human Settlements (IIHS), Bengaluru
 - ✓ Period: Late 2024–Early 2025
 - ✓ Type: AI-based acoustic monitoring device

- ✓ Status: India's first automated real-time bat detection system
- Key Features
 - ✓ AI Classification:
 - Algorithm: Convolutional Neural Network (CNN)
 - Function: Identify bat species via echolocation calls
 - Basis: Ultrasonic call structure + peak frequency
 - ✓ Autonomous Operation:
 - Activation: At sunset
 - Duration: Whole night recording
 - Feature: Real-time noise filtering (insects, machinery)
 - ✓ Hardware:
 - Audiomoth: Ultrasonic microphone
 - Processor: Raspberry Pi
 - Power: Solar-powered
 - Design: Portable (forest, farm, urban use)

Q 139. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Mission Fram2 nature: Fully commercial private spaceflight
 - ✓ Operating company: SpaceX
 - ✓ Spacecraft used: Crew Dragon Resilience
 - ✓ Government agency collaboration: Not involved
 - ✓ Mission funding: Private, civilian-funded mission
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Historic achievement: First human spaceflight in a 90-degree polar orbit
 - ✓ Orbital path: Passed directly over the North Pole and the South Pole
 - ✓ Orbital inclination achieved: About 90.01 degrees
 - ✓ Previous crewed orbit record: Vostok 6 mission inclination 65 degrees
 - ✓ ISS orbital inclination: About 51.6 degrees
 - ✓ Mission significance: First crewed polar orbit in spaceflight history
- Statement 3 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Mission orbit range: Low Earth Orbit
 - ✓ Orbital altitude: About 413 km to 450 km
 - ✓ Lunar travel claim: Incorrect

- ✓ Actual achievement: First human X-ray conducted in space
- ✓ Experiment name: SpaceXray project
- ✓ Purpose: Test diagnostic capability for deep-space missions

● Additional Facts:

- ✓ Crew and mission details:
 - Mission duration: About 3.5 days
- ✓ Mission commander and funder: Chun Wang
- ✓ Crew member:
 - Eric Philips, polar adventurer
 - Jannicke Mikkelsen, film director
 - Rabea Rogge, robotics researcher

Q 140. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Covered entities: Commercial Banks
 - ✓ Regulatory coverage: All commercial banks are included under the RBI Digital Lending Directions
 - ✓ Applicability: Mandatory compliance for digital lending activities
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Covered entities: Co-operative Banks
 - ✓ Types included:
 - Primary Co-operative Banks
 - State Co-operative Banks
 - Central Co-operative Banks
- Statement 3 is correct:
 - ✓ Covered entities: Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs)
 - ✓ Additional inclusion: Housing Finance Companies (HFCs)
 - ✓ Applicability: Digital lending operations regulated under the RBI framework
- Statement 4 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Insurance companies: Not covered under RBI Digital Lending Directions
 - ✓ Correct regulator: Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI)
 - ✓ Core reason: Insurance sector is regulated separately from the RBI credit framework
- Statement 5 is correct:
 - ✓ New inclusion in 2025 update: All India Financial Institutions (AIFIs)
 - ✓ Significance: Expansion beyond earlier 2022 coverage

- ✓ Compliance requirement: Mandatory adherence if engaged in digital lending
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Reserve Bank of India Digital Lending Directions:
 - Updated year: 2025
 - Issuing authority: Reserve Bank of India
 - Scope: Governs all Regulated Entities participating in digital lending
 - ✓ All India Financial Institutions covered:
 - NABARD: National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development
 - SIDBI: Small Industries Development Bank of India
 - EXIM Bank: Export-Import Bank of India
 - NHB: National Housing Bank
 - NaBFID: National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development
 - ✓ Digital Lending App regulation:
 - Mandatory portal: Centralised Information Management System (CIMS)
 - Requirement: Registration of all Digital Lending Apps
 - Coverage: Proprietary apps and third-party Lending Service Providers
 - ✓ Data governance provisions:
 - Condition: Data must be repatriated to India
 - Deletion rule: Data must be erased from foreign servers within 24 hours
- ✓ Strategic aim: Promote clean and sustainable energy generation
- Statement 3 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Heavy automobile manufacturing: Not identified as a focus sector
 - ✓ Geographical limitation: Hilly terrain and ecological sensitivity
 - ✓ Seismic risk factor: High seismic vulnerability in the region
 - ✓ Industrial suitability: Heavy manufacturing unsuitable for fragile terrain
 - ✓ Major automobile hubs in India: Tamil Nadu (Chennai), Maharashtra (Pune), Gujarat (Sanand), Haryana (Manesar)
- Statement 4 is correct:
 - ✓ Sector focus: Infrastructure, textiles, handicrafts and tourism
 - ✓ Infrastructure emphasis: Economic corridors and logistics networks
 - ✓ Tourism type promoted: Sustainable ecotourism
 - ✓ Textile strength: Traditional handicrafts and indigenous textile industries
- Additional facts:
 - ✓ Rising North East Investors Summit
 - Edition year: 2025
 - Organising ministry: Ministry of Development of North Eastern Region (MDoNER)
 - Venue: Bharat Mandapam
 - City: New Delhi
 - ✓ Policy linkage:
 - Guiding vision: Ashta Lakshmis concept for the eight northeastern states
 - Strategic policy: Act East Policy
 - Regional role: Gateway to Southeast Asia and ASEAN markets
- ✓ Total investment proposals received: ₹4.3 lakh crore
 - Major investor: Reliance Industries
 - ◇ Reliance investment commitment: ₹75,000 crore
 - ◇ Investment areas: Agriculture, digital services and telecom
 - Major investor: Adani Group
 - ◇ Adani investment commitment: ₹50,000 crore
 - ◇ Investment areas: Infrastructure and green energy
- ✓ Infrastructure support initiatives:

Q 141. Ans. B

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Sector focus: Agriculture and allied sectors
 - ✓ Key component: Food processing industries
 - ✓ Selection basis: Region's strong agricultural base
 - ✓ Resource advantage: Availability of organic and GI-tagged products
 - ✓ Examples of GI products: Assam tea, Joha rice, Kachai lemon
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Sector focus: Renewable energy
 - ✓ Major component: Hydropower development
 - ✓ Selection basis: Large untapped hydropower potential in the North-Eastern Region

- Total national highway network length in NER: Over 16,200 km
- Gas infrastructure project: Northeast Gas Grid
- Total planned gas grid length: About 1,600 km
- Strategic connectivity project: Kaladan Multi-Modal Transit Transport Project
- Strategic tunnel project:
 - ◇ Sela Tunnel:
 - ◇ Between Guwahati in Assam and Tawang in Arunachal Pradesh.
 - ◇ This tunnel is the longest bi-lane tunnel in the world at 13,000 feet.

- Troop contribution system: Voluntary by UN member states
- Budget structure: Separate from the regular UN budget
- ✓ India's role in peacekeeping:
 - Major diplomatic initiative: Group of Friends to Promote Accountability for Crimes Against Peacekeepers
- ✓ Recent host history of UN Peacekeeping Ministerial:
 - 2023 host city: Accra, Ghana
 - 2021 host city: Seoul, South Korea

Q 142. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ United Nations Peacekeeping Ministerial 2025
 - ✓ Host country: Germany
 - ✓ Host city: Berlin
 - ✓ Event month and year: May 2025
 - ✓ Key theme: Future of Peacekeeping
 - ✓ Priority areas: Use of Artificial Intelligence and Unmanned Aerial Systems
 - ✓ Operational focus: Transition to renewable energy in peacekeeping missions
 - ✓ Additional milestone: Linked with the 80th anniversary of the United Nations
- Statement 2 is incorrect:
 - ✓ India ranking: Fourth largest active troop contributor
 - ✓ Largest active contributor: Nepal
 - ✓ Second largest contributor: Rwanda
 - ✓ Third largest contributor: Bangladesh
 - ✓ India is the largest cumulative contributor since 1948
 - ✓ Total Indian personnel deployed historically: Over 2.7 lakh
- Statement 3 is incorrect:
 - ✓ 2025 Ministerial specifically commemorated the 10-year anniversary of the Leaders' Summit on Peacekeeping.
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ UN Peacekeeping Fundamentals:
 - Primary mandate authority: UN Security Council
 - Peacekeeping personnel name: Blue Helmets

Q 143. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Space Docking Experiment (SpaDeX)
 - ✓ Docking components: Two satellites, SDX01 and SDX02
 - ✓ Satellite roles: SDX01 Chaser, SDX02 Target
 - ✓ Satellite mass: About 220 kg each
 - ✓ Orbit altitude: 475 km Low Earth Orbit (LEO)
 - ✓ Key achievement: Successful in-orbit physical docking
- Statement 2 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Actual launch vehicle: PSLV-C60
 - ✓ GSLV is used for heavier payload missions
- Statement 3 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Global significance: India became 4th country to master space docking
 - ✓ Countries ahead of India: United States, Russia, China
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Strategic mission relevance:
 - Supports mission: Chandrayaan-4 lunar sample return mission
 - ✓ PSLV Orbital Experimental Module linkage:
 - Platform used: PSLV Orbital Experimental Module-4 (POEM-4)
 - Source of module: Repurposed 4th stage of PSLV
 - ✓ Industrial collaboration details:
 - Design centre: U R Rao Satellite Centre (URSC)
 - Final assembly and testing partner: Ananth Technologies

- Sectoral significance: Expansion of public-private partnership in the space sector

Q 144. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ UN-CEBD full form: UN Committee of Experts on Big Data and Data Science for Official Statistics
 - ✓ Established by: UN Statistical Commission
 - ✓ Year of establishment: March 2014
 - ✓ Primary purpose: Integrate Big Data into official statistical systems
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Core mandate: Use non-traditional data sources for official statistics
 - ✓ Examples of data sources: Satellite imagery, mobile data
 - ✓ Major application area: Monitoring and reporting Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)
 - ✓ Operational support system: UN Global Platform and specialised task teams
- Statement 3 is incorrect:
 - ✓ India joined UN-CEBD: January 2025
 - ✓ Announcing ministry: Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ UN Statistical Commission details:
 - Established year: 1947
 - Status: The highest global decision-making body on statistical activities
 - India membership term: January 1, 2024 to December 31, 2027
 - Gap before recent membership: About two decades
 - ✓ Domestic policy linkage:
 - Lead ministry in India: Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)
 - Key initiative: Data Innovation Lab
 - Objective: Integrate IoT, machine learning and scanner data into statistical systems
 - Policy aim: Reduce time lag in macroeconomic indicators
 - ✓ Global engagement:
 - UN Statistical Commission: India member for the 2024–2027 term

- Global Partnership on Artificial Intelligence (GPAI): India is founding member in the year 2020.
- Strategic impact: Enables India to shape global data governance standards and represent Global South priorities

Q 145. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Assertion (A) is correct:
 - ✓ India's first analog space mission: Launched at Leh, Ladakh
 - ✓ Launch time: November 2024
 - ✓ Site selection basis: Cold arid desert in the rain-shadow region of the Himalayas
 - ✓ Environmental similarity: Barren terrain, extreme isolation, low oxygen and large diurnal temperature variation.
 - ✓ Temperature range: About 15°C to –10°C
 - ✓ Oxygen availability: About 40% of sea level
 - ✓ Purpose: Simulate harsh, dry conditions similar to the Moon and Mars environments.
- Reason (R) is incorrect:
 - ✓ Actual climatic condition: Very low rainfall due to rain-shadow location
 - ✓ Planetary simulation requirement: Dry and arid terrain, not high precipitation zones.
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Nodal and collaborating agencies:
 - Lead agency: ISRO Human Spaceflight Centre (HSFC)
 - Collaborators: AAKA Space Studio, University of Ladakh, IIT Bombay
 - Local administrative partner: Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Council (LAHDC)
 - ✓ Strategic relevance:
 - Supports mission: Gaganyaan human spaceflight programme
 - Future infrastructure target: Bharatiya Antariksha Station by 2035
 - Long-term goal: Crewed lunar landing by 2040
 - Research focus: Human survival under isolation and low-pressure conditions
 - ✓ Subsequent development:
 - Follow-up mission: Himalayan Outpost for Planetary Exploration (HOPE)
 - Location: Tso Kar Valley, Ladakh

- Site characteristics: High UV radiation and saline permafrost suitable for Martian simulation.

Q 146. Ans. B

Explanation:

- New Pamban Bridge
 - ✓ Location: Tamil Nadu
 - ✓ Connects: Mandapam (mainland) → Rameswaram Island
 - ✓ Replaces: Old Pamban Bridge
 - ✓ Type: Railway sea bridge
- Unique Feature
 - ✓ Design: Vertical lift span
 - ✓ Span length: 72.5 meters

Additional Information

- Chenab Rail Bridge:
 - ✓ Location: Jammu & Kashmir
 - ✓ Feature: World's highest railway arch bridge
 - ✓ River: Chenab
- Bogibeel Bridge:
 - ✓ Location: Assam
 - ✓ Feature: India's longest rail-cum-road bridge
 - ✓ River: Brahmaputra
- Anji Khad Bridge:
 - ✓ Location: Jammu & Kashmir
 - ✓ Feature: India's first cable-stayed railway bridge
 - ✓ Route: Katra–Reasi

Q 147. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Namo Bharat Rapid Rail in Bihar: Jayanagar to Patna
 - ✓ Intermediate major stations: Sakri, Darbhanga, Samastipur, Barauni, Mokama
 - ✓ Regional significance: First Namo Bharat Rapid Rail in Bihar
 - ✓ Regional significance: First Namo Bharat Rapid Rail in Eastern India
 - ✓ Inauguration: April 2025
 - ✓ Inaugurated by: Prime Minister Narendra Modi
 - ✓ Launch location: Madhubani
 - ✓ Launch occasion: National Panchayati Raj Day on April 24

- ✓ Key objective: Reduce intercity travel time across the Mithilanchal region

- Train Features and Technology:
 - ✓ Train category: Semi-high-speed regional rail
 - ✓ Earlier name: Vande Metro
 - ✓ Design purpose: Short-distance intercity and suburban travel
 - ✓ Operational distance range: 100 km to 350 km
 - ✓ Train technology: Push-pull system with engines at both ends
- National significance: First Namo Bharat train with 16-coach formation
 - ✓ Passenger capacity: Over 2,000 passengers (sitting and standing)
 - ✓ Safety system: Integrated with Kavach Automatic Train Protection
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Earlier prototype service:
 - First prototype route: Ahmedabad to Bhuj
 - ✓ Economic and regional significance:
 - Target region: Mithilanchal
 - Primary aim: Connect Tier-II and Tier-III cities to major urban hubs
 - ✓ Future proposed corridor: Muzaffarpur to Patna
 - ✓ India's first Amrit Bharat Express route: Darbhanga to Anand Vihar (New Delhi)

Q 148. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ 7th Khelo India Youth Games (KIYG): Hosted by Bihar
 - ✓ Edition: 7th
 - ✓ Year: 2025
 - ✓ Month held: May 2025
 - ✓ Host cities in Bihar: Patna, Rajgir, Gaya, Bhagalpur, Begusarai
 - ✓ Co-host city: New Delhi
 - ✓ Significance: First multi-disciplinary national sporting event hosted by Bihar
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Sepaktakraw: Introduced as a medal sport for the first time in KIYG history
 - ✓ Nature of sport: Traditional Southeast Asian kick-volleyball sport

- ✓ Reason for inclusion: India's gold medal victory at ISTAF World Cup
- ✓ Additional inclusion: Esports introduced as a demonstration sport for the first time
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Scheme origin and objectives:
 - Khelo India Youth Games launch year: 2018
 - Original name: Khelo India School Games
 - Administrative ministry: Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports
 - Target categories: Under-17 and Under-21 athletes
 - Long-term linkage: Feeds talent into the Target Olympic Podium Scheme (TOPS)
 - ✓ State-level initiatives linked to KIYG 2025:
 - Scheme launched by Bihar: Medal Lao Naukri Pao
 - Benefit: Direct government employment for medal winners
 - Scholarship range: ₹3 lakh to ₹20 lakh
 - ✓ Performance and rankings:
 - Overall champion KIYG 2025: Maharashtra
 - Total medals won by Maharashtra: 158
 - Champion status: Third consecutive KIYG title
 - Runner-up state: Haryana
 - Host state Bihar performance: 15th rank
 - Significance for Bihar: Best-ever KIYG performance
 - ✓ Recent KIYG Hosts and Champions:
 - 5th Edition 2023 host: Madhya Pradesh
 - 5th Edition 2023 champion: Maharashtra
 - 6th Edition 2024 host: Tamil Nadu
 - 6th Edition 2024 champion: Maharashtra
- ✓ Core objective: Develop foundational GenAI models for Indian languages
- ✓ Design focus: Indian socio-cultural contexts and linguistic diversity
- ✓ Model type: Open-source foundational model
- ✓ Ecosystem purpose: Enable startups, researchers, and government bodies to build AI applications
- ✓ Strategic goal: Ensure data sovereignty in India's AI infrastructure
- ✓ Policy significance: Reduce dependence on foreign proprietary AI models
- Statement 2 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Lead institution: IIT Bombay
 - ✓ Executing hub: Technology Innovation Hub for Internet of Things (IoT) and Everything
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Administrative framework:
 - Parent mission: National Mission on Interdisciplinary Cyber-Physical Systems (NM-ICPS)
 - Nodal department: Department of Science and Technology (DST)
 - Administrative ministry: Ministry of Science and Technology
 - ✓ Synergy with other national initiatives:
 - Bhashini initiative: National Language Translation Mission
 - Implementing ministry of Bhashini: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)
 - Bhashini focus: Translation and voice-based language tools
 - BharatGen role: Provides an advanced Generative AI backbone for Indian-language applications
 - ✓ Other major AI ecosystem initiatives in India:
 - IndiaAI Mission:
 - ◇ Implemented by MeitY
 - ◇ Develop a national AI ecosystem and compute capacity
 - AIRAWAT:
 - ◇ India's flagship AI Supercomputer
 - ◇ Implementing agency: Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC)
 - ◇ Location: Pune

Q 149. Ans. A

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ BharatGen: Government-funded Generative AI initiative
 - ✓ Nature: First-of-its-kind sovereign Generative AI programme

Q 150. Ans. C

Explanation:

- Statement 1 is correct:
 - ✓ Mission Mausam tagline: Weather Ready and Climate Smart
 - ✓ Primary aim: Upgrade India's atmospheric observation network and forecasting systems
 - ✓ Numerical Weather Prediction resolution upgrade: 12 km to 6 km
 - ✓ Forecasting target: Hyper-local Panchayat-level forecasts
 - ✓ Nowcasting frequency improvement: 3 hours to 1 hour
 - ✓ Observation network expansion: Installation of 87 Doppler Weather Radars
 - ✓ Additional systems: Wind profilers and expanded High Performance Computing
 - ✓ High-Performance Computing (HPC) capacity target: Up to 20 petaflops
- Statement 2 is correct:
 - ✓ Unique objective: Shift from weather prediction to weather management
 - ✓ Weather modification techniques: Cloud seeding, fog dispersal, hail suppression
 - ✓ Key infrastructure: Convective Cloud Chamber
 - ✓ Location of facility: IITM Pune
 - ✓ Supporting research base: CAIPEEX programme
- ✓ CAIPEEX full form: Cloud Aerosol Interaction and Precipitation Enhancement Experiment
- ✓ Rainfall enhancement under CAIPEEX: 18% to 46% in rain-shadow regions
- Statement 3 is incorrect:
 - ✓ Correct implementing ministry: Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)
- Additional Facts:
 - ✓ Mission launch details:
 - Phase I outlay: ₹2,000 crore
 - Phase I duration: 2024–2026
 - ✓ Nodal implementing institutions under MoES:
 - India Meteorological Department (IMD): Observations and forecasting
 - Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology (IITM), Pune: Cloud physics and experimental systems
 - National Centre for Medium-Range Weather Forecasting (NCMRWF), Noida: Data assimilation and numerical modelling
 - ✓ Wider national significance:
 - Improves disaster preparedness and response
 - Protects agriculture from extreme weather variability
 - Reduces aviation disruptions
 - Protects power infrastructure from lightning-related risks

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